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China Economics

China Macro Outlook 26H2-2027

Approaching Inflection

Xiangrong Yu, PhD [AC]
Managing Director
Head of Greater China Economics
xiangrong.yu@citi.com
+852 2501-2574

Xinyu Ji [AC]
Vice President
China Economist
xinyu.ji@citi.com
+852 2501-2792

Yuanliu Hu [AC]
Vice President
China Economist
yuanliu.hu@citi.com
+852 2501-2746

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Thesis – Approaching Inflection

- **Challenging 2026, More Challenging 2027:** The domestic economy is on the verge of recession, but headline growth should still meet target this year, supported by investment-led cyclical stabilization ahead. The government may be pressed to **"protect 4" (保四) in 2027** amid headwinds: **[1]** export engine slows down; **[2]** property deepens as a drag post home-sales reform; and **[3]** entrenched weak confidence turns to faster deleveraging. **Deflation will return** once oil prices normalize. We forecast GDP growth slowing from 4.6% in 2026E to 4.1% in 2027E, and PPI inflation falling from 2.8% to 0.4%.
- **Approaching Policy Inflection Point:** A "9.24"-style pivot looks inevitable in 2027, if not sooner, as pressures build from slowing growth, rising unemployment, widening fiscal gaps, and resurfacing deflation. We expect the **augmented fiscal deficit to increase ~RMB2trn** — RMB1trn on-budget plus RMB500bn each in special CGB and LGB quotas — partly offsetting ~RMB1trn decline in land revenue following home-sales reform. As conventional measures show diminishing impact, it's time for **more direct household transfers**, in our view. Risk-resolution efforts may also shift toward **clearing payment arrears** as local debt swap winds down. We pencil in **two 10bp policy rate cuts** following a hold in 2026.
- **Global Tech Power Rebalancing:** The dominant theme for China investing has shifted from **consumption upgrade** to **tech upgrade**. Chinese manufacturers have emerged stronger from tariff, Covid, and energy shocks. Tech & innovation, namely "**new productive forces (新质生产力)**", will mark the next phase of upgrade. With its industrial ecosystem, infrastructure, talent pool, and policy push, China has the potential to become a major global center for "**AI+ economy**", spanning both models and hardware — just as it previously rewrote global manufacturing supply chains, from textiles to autos.
- **Market Implications:** China rates are set to stay **lower for longer**. FX is caught between record-high trade surplus and record-high yield differential. We expect **managed RMB appreciation** toward 6.5 per US dollar in 2027E. Foreign holdings of A-shares have held more steady than expected, though a **K-shaped equity market** may persist.

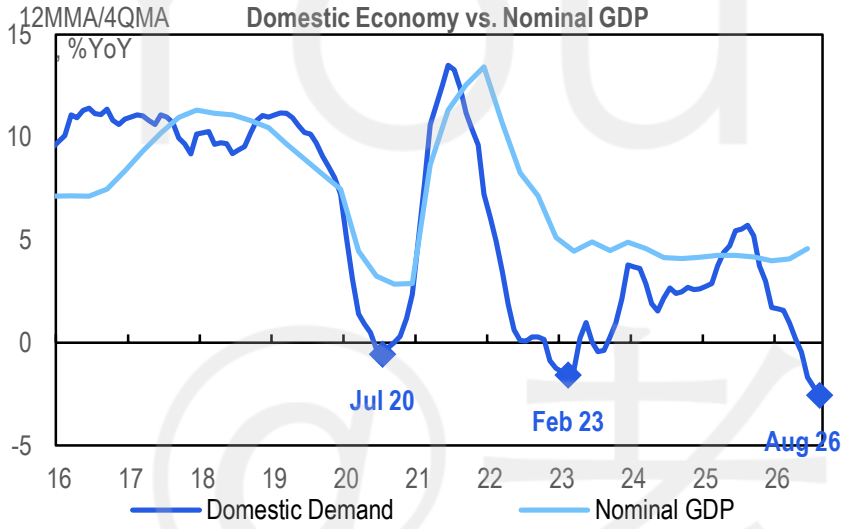
Key Economic Forecasts

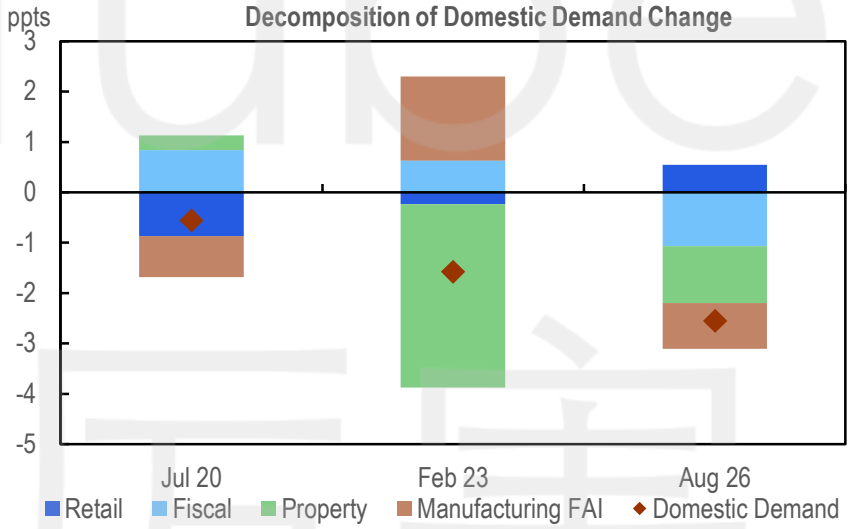
	Unit	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026F	2027E	24Q4	25Q1	25Q2	25Q3F	25Q4	26Q1	26Q2	26Q3F	26Q4F	27Q1F	27Q2F	27Q3F	27Q4F
Real GDP	%YoY	6.1	2.3	8.6	3.1	5.4	5.0	5.0	4.6	4.1	5.4	5.4	5.2	4.8	4.5	5.0	4.3	4.5	4.6	4.3	4.1	3.9	4.0
	%QoQ										*1.6*	*1.1*	*1.2*	*1.1*	*1.1*	*1.3*	*0.9*	***0.9***	***1.3***	***1.3***	***0.5***	***0.8***	***1.3***
Consumption	ppt	3.6	-0.1	5.2	1.5	4.6	2.3	2.6	2.3	2.4	1.7	2.7	2.7	2.6	2.4	2.4	1.9						
Gross Capital Formation	ppt	1.8	1.8	1.7	1.2	1.4	1.1	0.8	1.2	1.1	1.2	0.3	1.3	0.8	0.7	1.9	1.5						
Net Exports	ppt	0.7	0.7	1.7	0.4	-0.6	1.5	1.6	1.1	0.5	2.5	2.4	1.3	1.4	1.4	0.8	0.9						
Nominal GDP	%YoY	7.5	2.9	13.4	5.1	4.9	4.2	4.0	6.3	4.5	4.5	4.5	3.8	3.7	3.8	4.9	6.0	6.8	7.1	6.6	4.2	4.2	3.5
Industrial Production	%YoY	5.7	2.8	9.6	3.6	4.6	5.8	5.9	5.0	4.1	5.3	6.5	6.2	5.8	5.0	5.7	4.7	4.7	4.9	4.6	4.2	3.8	3.6
Services Sector Growth	%YoY	7.6	2.4	9.0	3.5	6.3	5.1	5.4	4.8	4.1	5.4	5.3	5.7	5.4	5.2	5.2	4.5	4.6	4.8	4.2	4.0	4.2	4.1
Nominal FAI	%YoY, Ytd	5.4	2.9	4.9	5.1	3.0	3.2	-3.8	-4.0	-4.0	3.2	4.2	2.8	-0.5	-3.8	1.7	-5.7		-4.0				-4.0
Property	%YoY, Ytd	9.9	7.0	4.4	-10.0	-9.6	-10.6	-17.2	-20.0	-30.0	-10.6	-9.9	-11.2	-13.9	-17.2	-11.2	-18.0		-20.0				-30.0
Infrastructure	%YoY, Ytd	3.8	0.9	0.4	9.4	5.9	4.4	-2.2	0.0	4.0	4.4	5.8	4.6	1.1	-2.2	8.9	-2.4		0.0				4.0
Manufacturing	%YoY, Ytd	3.1	-2.2	13.5	9.1	6.5	9.2	0.6	-1.0	0.0	9.2	9.1	7.5	4.0	0.6	4.1	-1.2		-1.0				0.0
Private FAI	%YoY, Ytd	4.7	1.0	7.0	0.9	-0.4	-0.1	-6.4			-0.1	0.4	-0.6	-3.1	-6.4	-2.2	-8.5						
Nominal Retail Sales	%YoY	8.0	-3.9	12.5	-0.2	7.2	3.5	3.7	1.2	2.0	3.9	4.6	5.4	3.4	1.7	2.4	0.2						
Exports	%YoY	0.5	3.6	29.9	7.0	-4.6	5.9	5.5	20.0	8.0	9.9	5.5	6.0	6.4	3.7	14.7	20.1	24.4	20.0	14.0	8.0	5.3	5.8
Imports	%YoY	-2.8	-1.1	30.1	1.1	-5.5	1.1	0.0	26.5	12.0	-1.7	-6.9	-0.9	4.6	3.6	23.6	29.4	26.5	26.0	15.0	10.0	12.0	11.5
Trade Balance	US$ bn	421	524	637	838	822	993	1180	1248	1216	298	271	312	287	310	259	315	343	331	288	323	303	301
Current Account	% of GDP	0.6	1.5	1.6	2.2	1.4	2.4	3.7	3.7	3.3	3.3	3.7	2.6	4.1	4.4	3.8	3.7						
GDP Deflator	%YoY	1.3	0.5	4.5	1.9	-0.5	-0.8	-1.0	1.7	0.5	-0.8	-0.8	-1.3	-1.1	-0.6	-0.1	1.6	2.2	2.4	2.2	0.1	0.3	-0.4
CPI	%YoY	2.9	2.5	0.9	2.0	0.2	0.2	0.0	1.0	0.6	0.2	-0.1	0.0	-0.2	0.6	0.8	1.1	0.8	1.2	1.0	0.5	0.9	0.0
PPI	%YoY	-0.3	-1.8	8.1	4.1	-3.0	-2.2	-2.6	2.8	0.4	-2.6	-2.3	-3.2	-2.9	-2.1	-0.6	3.6	3.9	4.4	3.0	-0.2	-0.1	-1.0
Budgetary Deficit	% of GDP	-2.7	-3.6	-3.0	-2.7	-3.8	-3.0	-4.0	-4.0	-4.5													
General Government Deficit	% of GDP						-8.7	-10.6	-10.6	-11.9													
M2	%YoY, EOP	8.7	10.1	9.0	11.8	9.7	7.3	8.5	7.2	6.9	7.3	7.0	8.3	8.4	8.5	8.5	8.0		7.2				6.9
Outstanding Loans	%YoY, EOP	12.3	12.8	11.6	11.1	10.6	7.6	6.4	5.0	4.6	7.6	7.4	7.1	6.6	6.4	5.7	5.2		5.0				4.6
New Loans	RMB trn	16.8	19.6	20.0	21.3	22.8	18.1	16.3	13.6	13.0	2.1	9.8	3.1	1.8	1.5	8.6	2.1						
TSF	%YoY, EOP	10.7	13.3	10.3	9.6	9.8	8.0	8.3	7.0	6.7	8.0	8.4	8.9	8.7	8.3	7.9	7.4		7.0				6.7
FX Reserves	US$ Bn, EOP	3,108	3,217	3,250	3,128	3,238	3,202	3,358	3,250	3,250	3,202	3,241	3,317	3,339	3,358	3,342	3,416		3,250				3,250
Policy Rate (7D Reverse Repo)	%, EOP	2.50	2.20	2.20	2.00	1.80	1.50	1.40	1.40	1.20	1.50	1.50	1.40	1.40	1.40	1.40	1.40	1.40	1.40	1.30	1.30	1.20	1.20
RRR (Large Banks)	%, EOP	13.00	12.50	11.50	11.00	10.50	9.50	9.00	9.00	8.50	9.50	9.50	9.00	9.00	9.00	9.00	9.00	9.00	9.00	9.00	8.50	8.50	8.50
USDCNY	EOP	7.0	6.5	6.4	7.0	7.1	7.3	7.0	6.6	6.5	7.3	7.3	7.2	7.1	7.0	6.9	6.8	6.7	6.6	6.6	6.5	6.5	6.5

BS, PBoC, SAFE, CEIC, Wind, Citi Research Forecasts

Domestic economy on the brink of recession despite solid headline growth

Domestic demand tracker has been lower than Covid-era lows in recent months;
Weakness is broad-based, cutting across households, government, and corporates



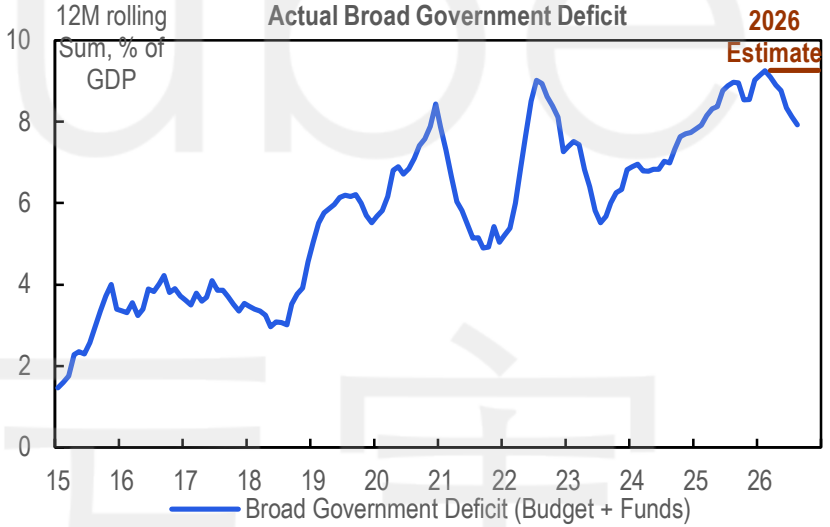


Note: we calculate domestic demand indicator as the sum of retail sales, general budgetary expenditure, government funds expenditure, property sales, and manufacturing FAI.
ind, Citi Research

Investment-led cyclical stabilization looks likely into year-end

Coordinated fiscal-monetary efforts have stepped up incrementally since August;
Earlier *de facto* austerity leaves room for more support ahead, with investment the focus

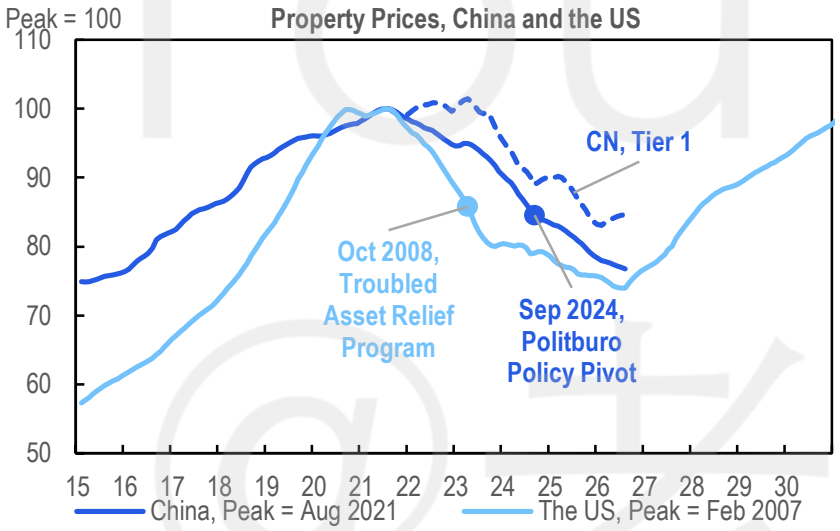
Date	Events and Measures
Jul 30	Politburo: incremental support, no policy pivot
Aug 7	Beijing eased purchase curbs; raised HPF loan limit
Aug 18	NDRC confirmed RMB800bn policy-financing tool
Aug 20	Shanghai cut downpayments; subsidized HPF loan interest
Aug 20	Nationwide expansion of HPF loan limits and coverage
Aug 28	Mortgage tenor extended to 40 years; hardship relief introduced
Mid-Aug to Sep	NDRC convened a series of "six networks" investment meetings
Sep 29	PSL rate cut and expanded use; higher relending quota; national mortgage interest subsidies for eligible homes (<120 sqm and <RMB1.5mn)



, CEIC, Citi Research

Mortgage subsidy is a net positive, though insufficient

Home prices have shown early signs for stabilization in T1 cities;
The subsidy (first-time buyer, ≤120sqm, ≤Rmb1.5mn) supports mass-market de-stocking in T3/4 cities and T2 city outskirts

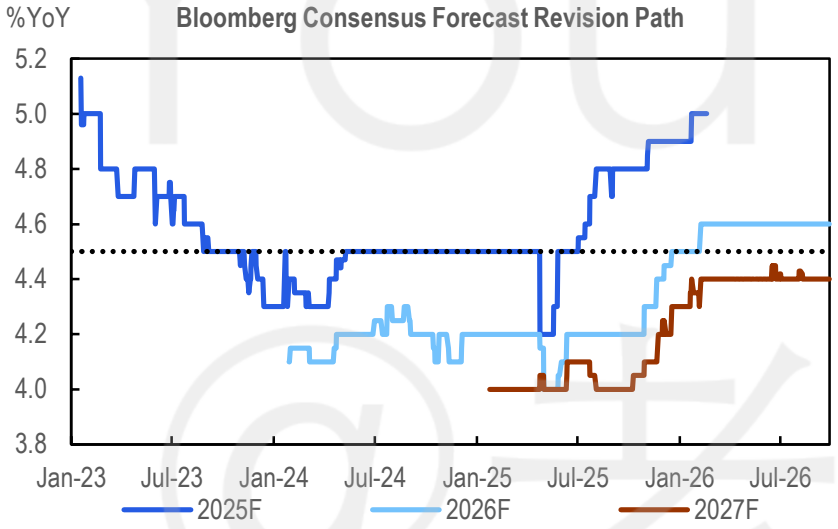


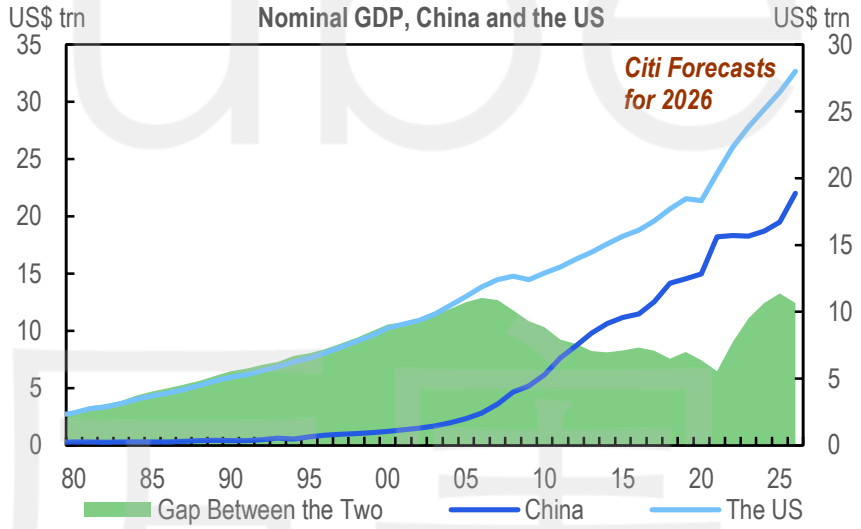
City Tier	New Homes (120 sq.m.&RMB1.5mn or below)		Secondary Homes (120sq.m.&RMB1.5mn or below)	
	2025	Jan-Aug 2026	2025	Jan-Aug 2026
40 cities total	33.6%	33.1%	56.3%	55.2%
Tier 1 (4 cities)	8.7%	7.8%	29.0%	27.4%
Tier 2 (26 cities)	36.5%	36.3%	64.1%	62.9%
Tier 3 & 4 (10 cities)	45.6%	44.3%	61.3%	59.8%

, CREIS, Haver Analytics, Wind, Citi Research, Citi China Property Research

Full-year growth target remains on track

Growth tracks a familiar strong-weak-strong path, keeping the full-year target within reach; US-China GDP gap set to narrow for the first time in six years on reflation and appreciation

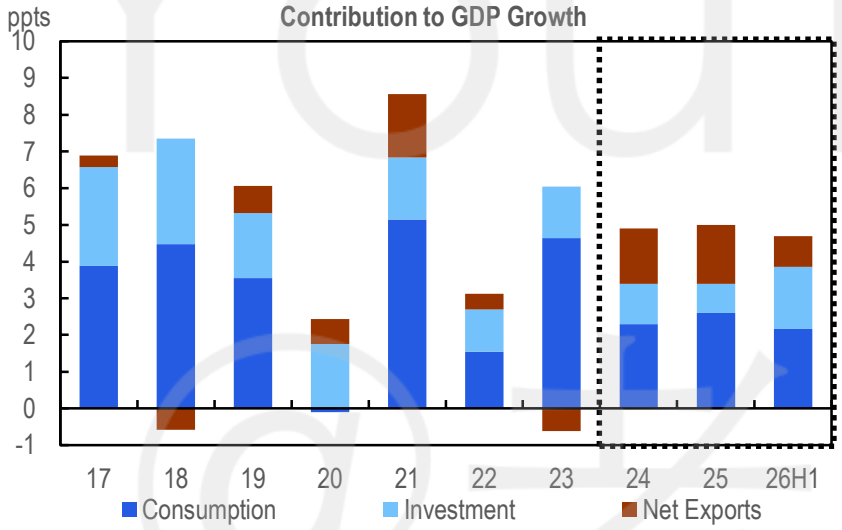


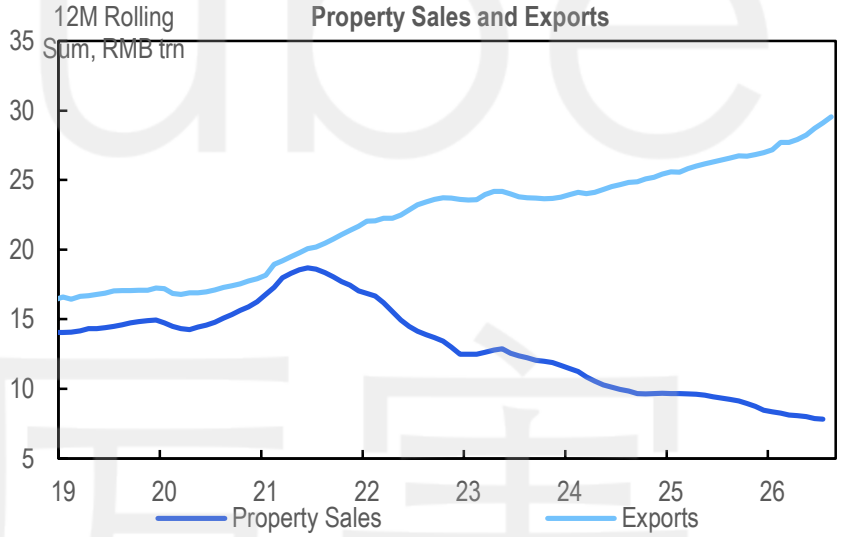


Source: Bloomberg, China NBS, US BEA, Haver Analytics, Citi Research Forecasts

Growth headwind 2027 [1]: Export engine cools down

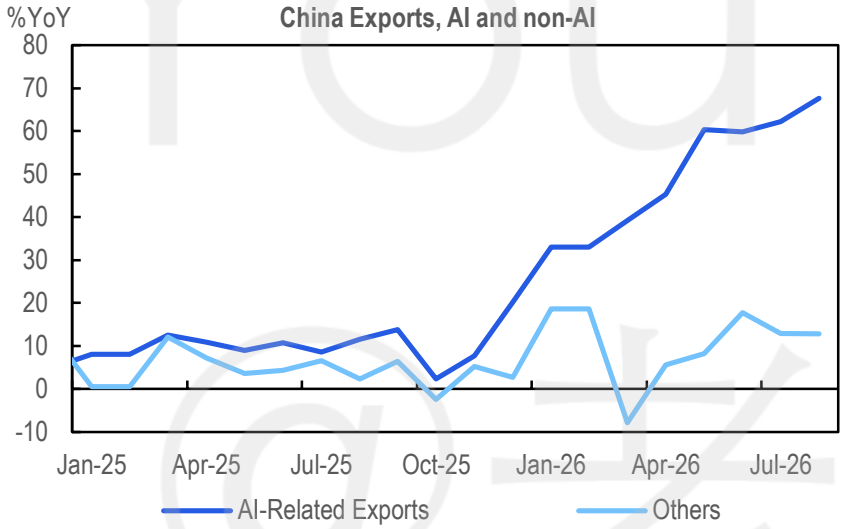
Net exports have single-handedly upheld GDP over the past three years;
Exports bridge the vast gap between supply and domestic demand in K-shaped growth

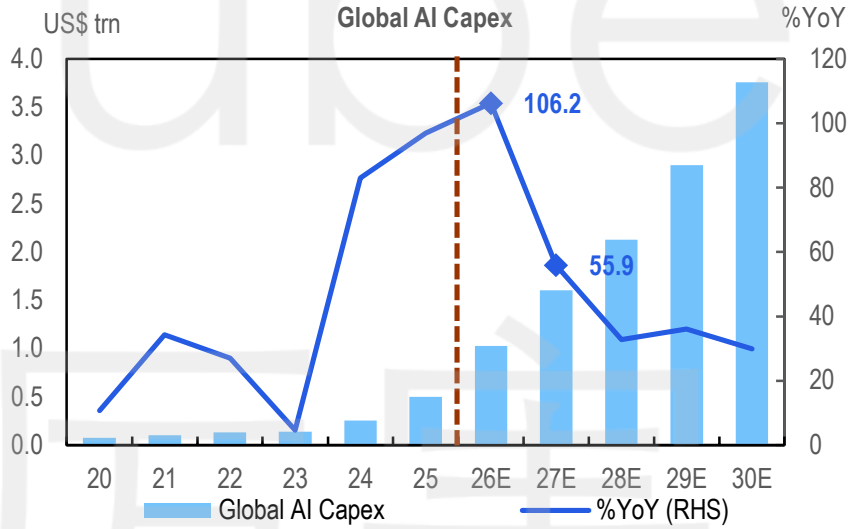




Skyrocketing AI exports to plateau

AI exports accounted for 27.4% of China's total exports in Jan-Aug 2026, up 50.9%YoY;
Citi expects global AI capex growth to peak at 106% in 2026E and moderate to 56% in 2027E

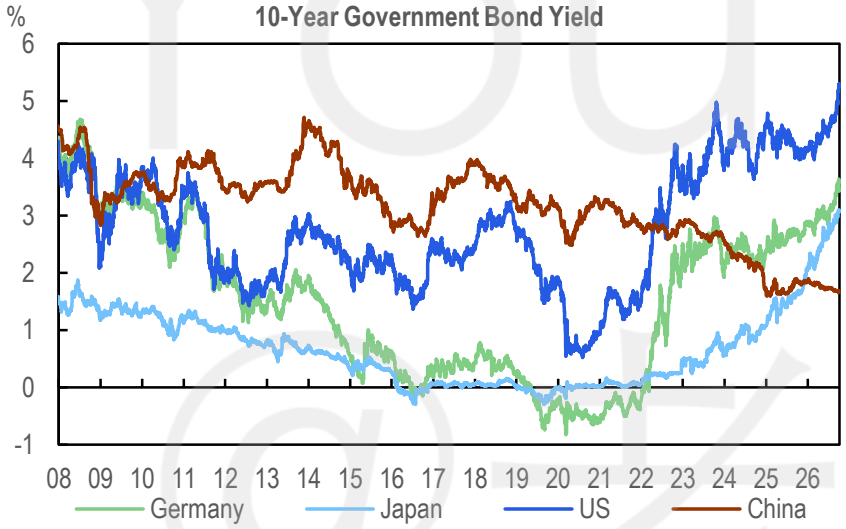




Note: See Will US AI Bans Derail Exports? for our classification of AI exports.
iti Research, Citi Global Tech Research

Higher-for-longer rates to weigh on non-AI exports

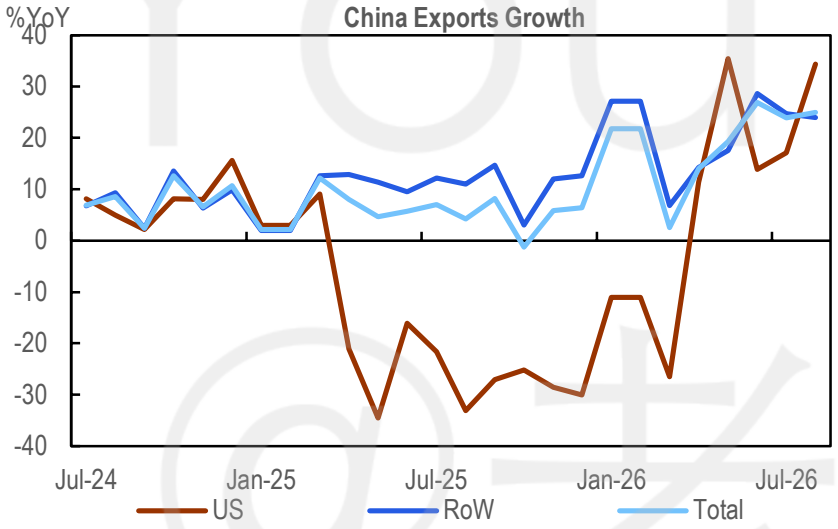
Interest- and price-sensitive non-AI trade is facing higher rates and energy uncertainty;
External demand is at risk should global resilience fade

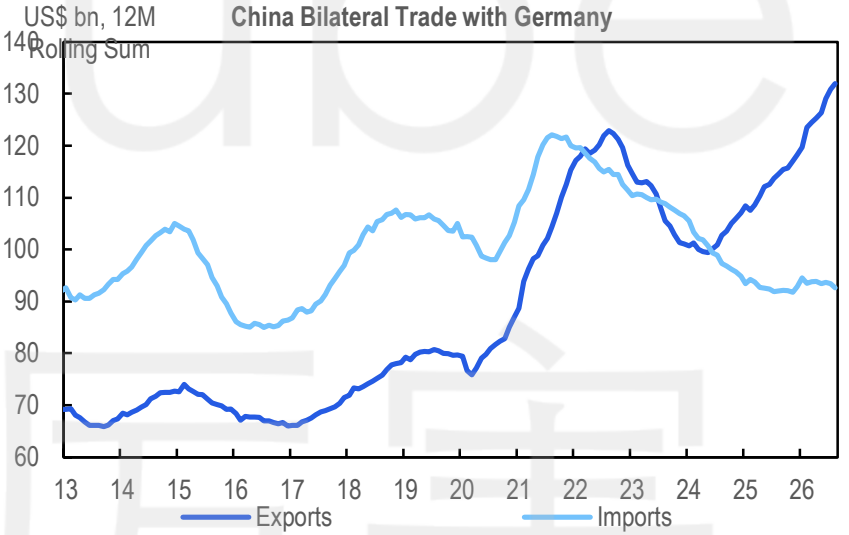




When US-China leaders meet less...

China-US exports rebounded 24.1%YoY in May-August as tariff impact faded;
EU-China trade tensions have reached a critical juncture as trade balance shifts

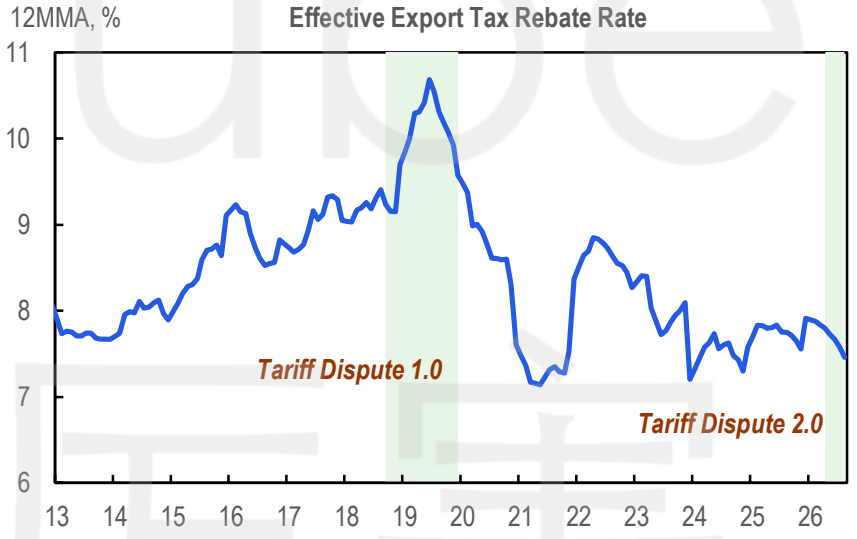




China “never deliberately pursues trade surplus”

Record US$1.2trn goods surplus (~40% of global total) leaves little room for expansion; Policy incentives to wind down further, with VAT rebate cuts (chemicals/batteries, Apr 2026) set to expand

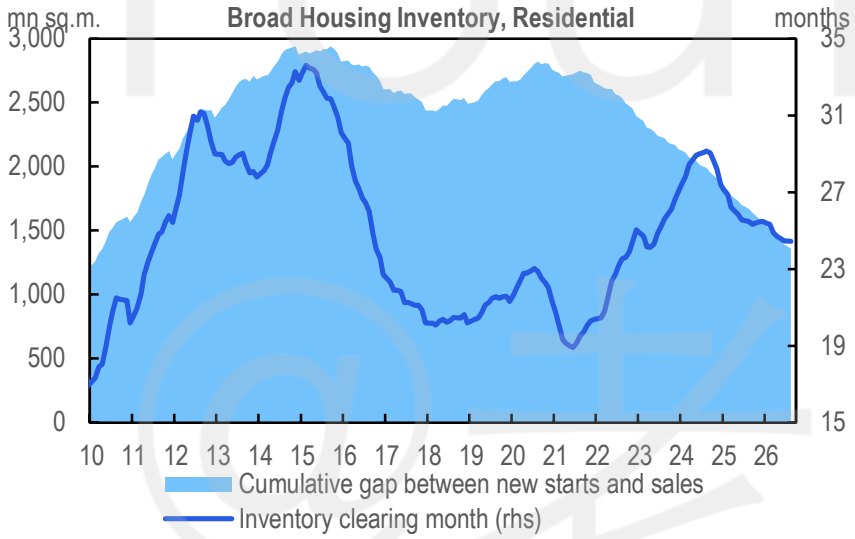


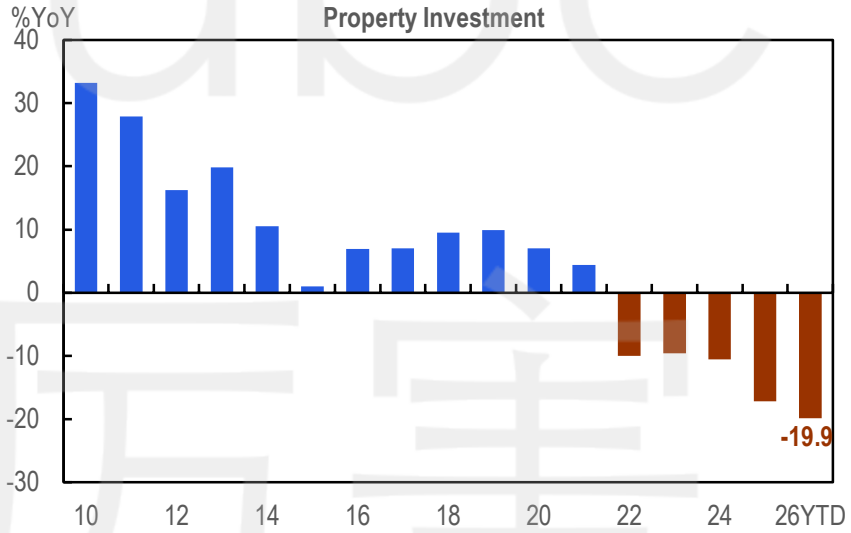


TS, MoF, Haver Analytics, Wind, Citi Research

Growth headwind 2027 [2]: Property drag deepens

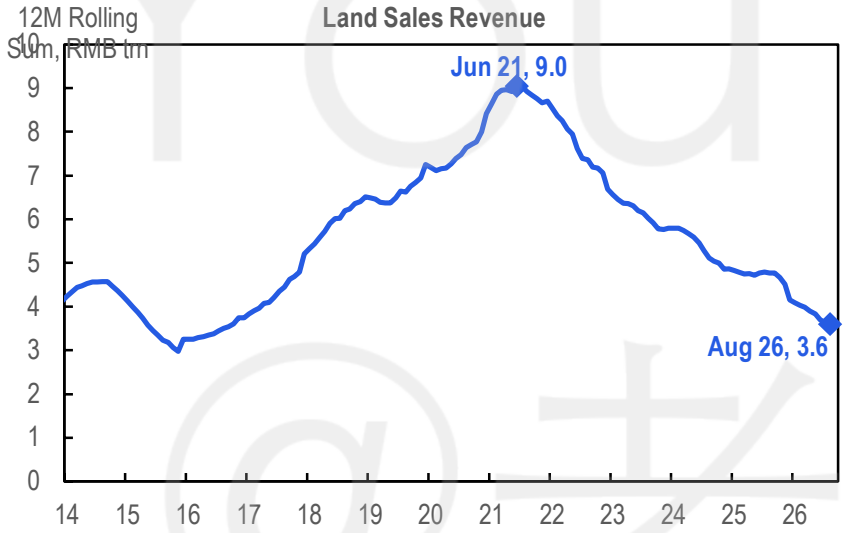
Completed-home sales reform should support price recovery in supply-squeezed core cities; New home volume and new starts could fall 30% as launch cycles stretch to 1.5-2.5 years (from 6-10 months), weighing further on investment

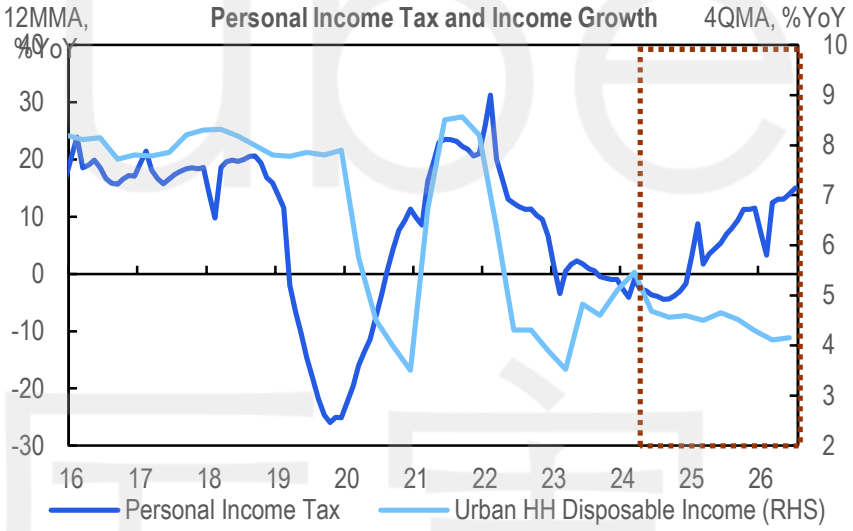




A bigger hole in local finance

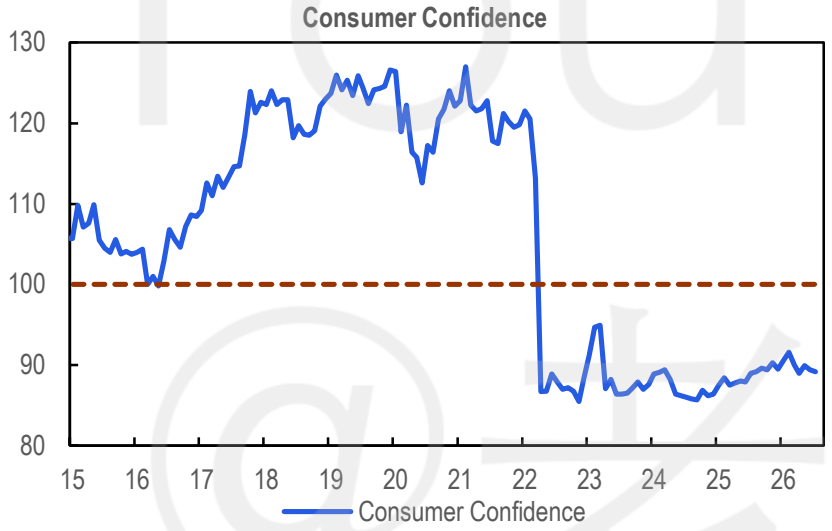
Land revenue dropped -28.6% YoY in Jan-Aug 2026, even before the home sales reform; Fiscal authorities have stepped their revenue collection efforts, from offshore trust taxes to social security contributions

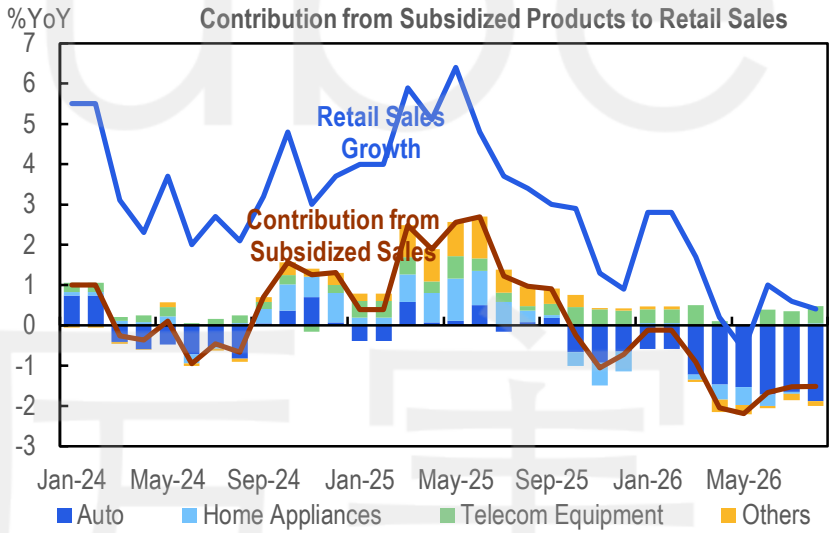




Growth headwind 2027 [3]: Weak confidence turns to faster deleveraging

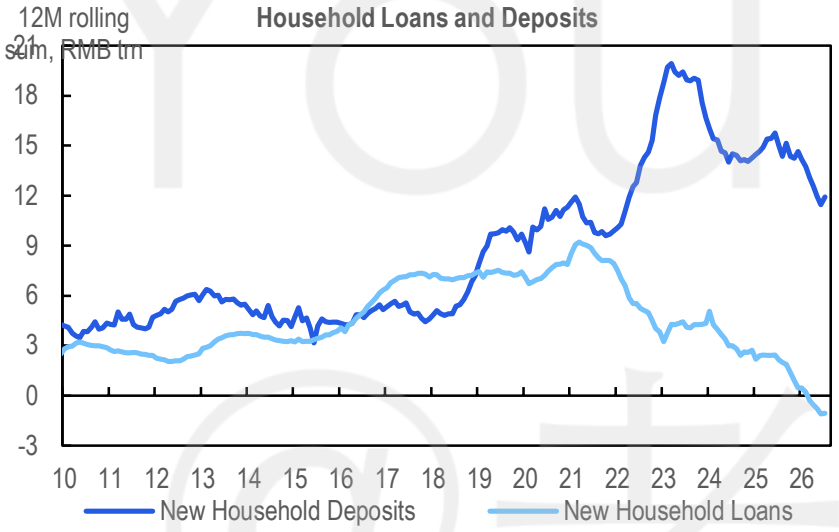
Consumer confidence has stayed low since 2022, harder to turn around the longer it lasts; Retail sales have barely grown this year as trade-in stimulus fades

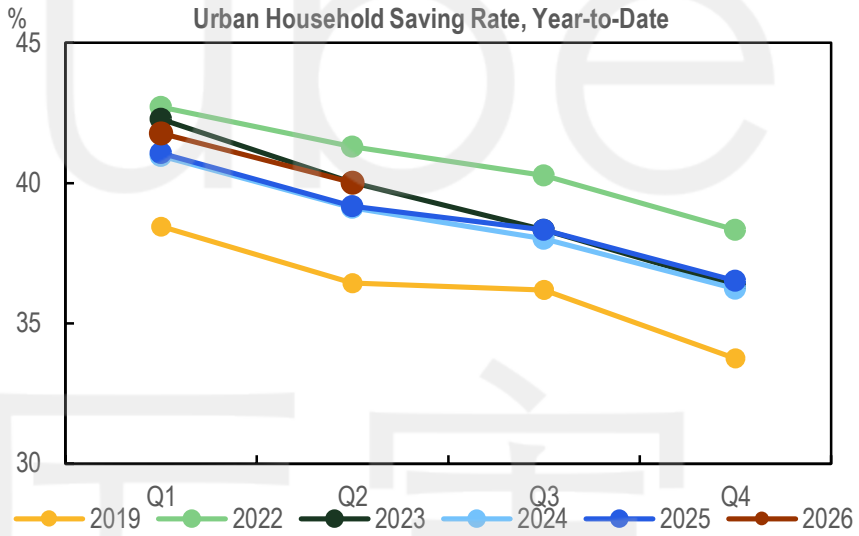




Households retreat from risk

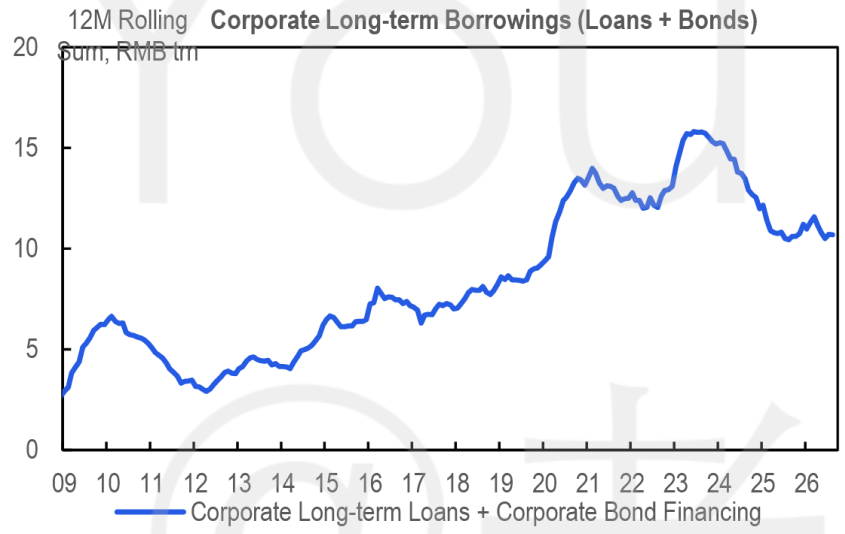
Households made net loan repayments of ~RMB1trn in Jan-Aug 2026;
Household savings rate held at an elevated 40.0% in 26H1 vs. 36.4% in 19H1

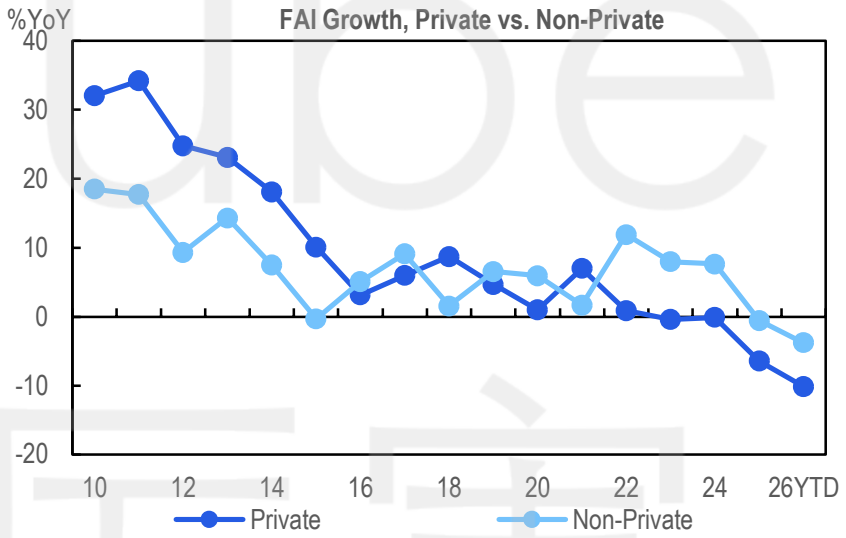




Corporates grow cautious as well

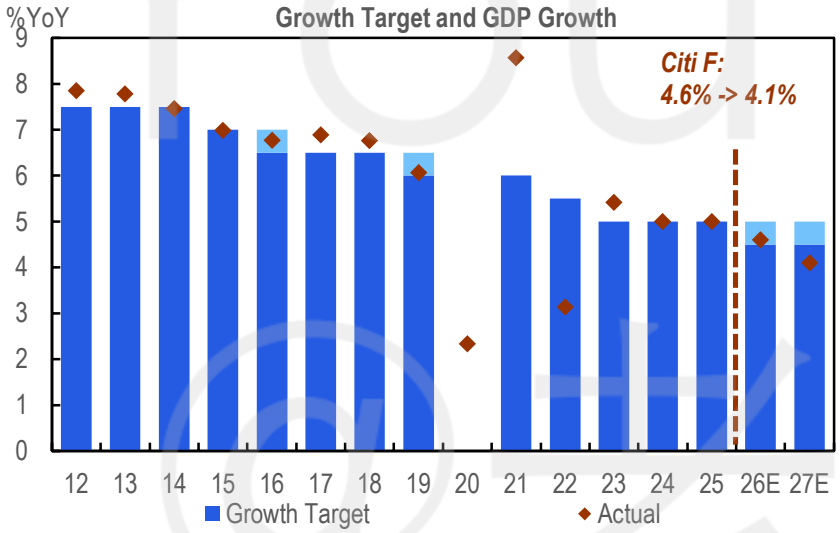
Corporate LT borrowings were at a five-year low, even including bond issuance;
Both SOEs and POEs are holding back on new capex, with private FAI down -10.1%YoY Ytd and non-private FAI down -3.8%YoY Ytd

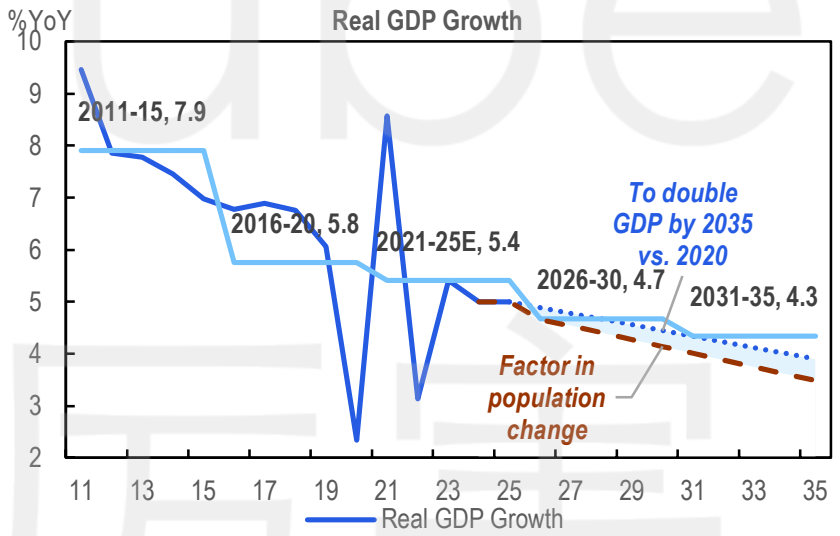




Medium-term growth targets under pressure

China has rarely cut GDP target by 0.5ppt in two consecutive years, except during Covid; The 15th FYP reiterates the goal of doubling 2020 GDP per capita by 2035, implying an average growth rate of 4.17% over 2026-35, even accounting for a shrinking population



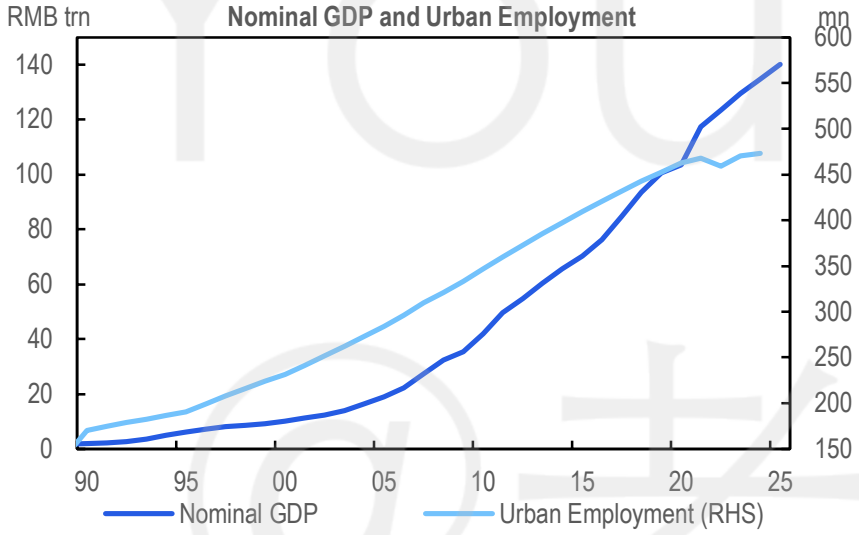


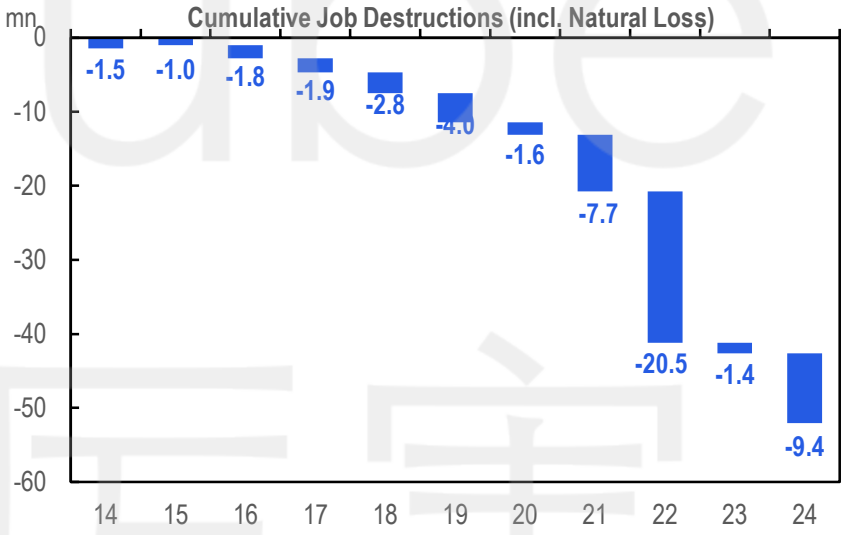
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on, Haver Analytics, Wind, Citi Research

Labor market under greater pressure: “jobless growth”?

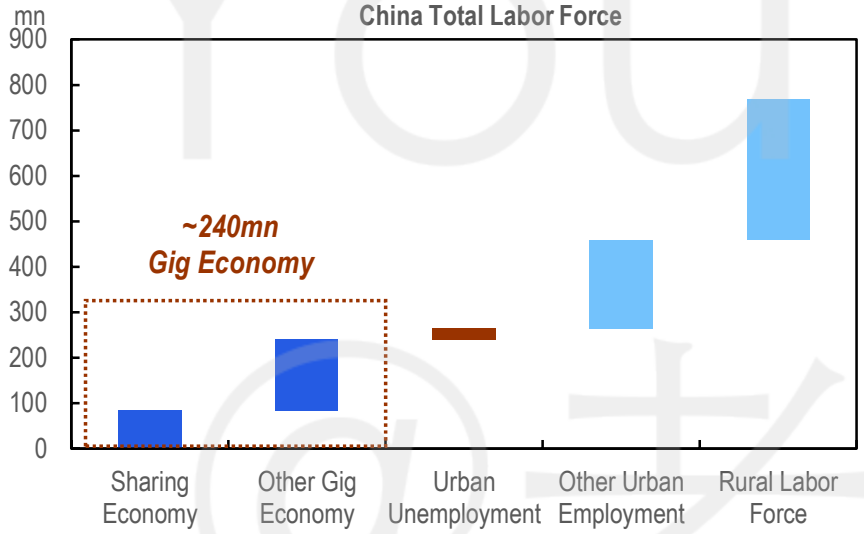
Urban employment looks to be peaking out in the 2020s;
Job loss (incl. natural reductions) could have accumulated to 53.6mn since the turn of 2014

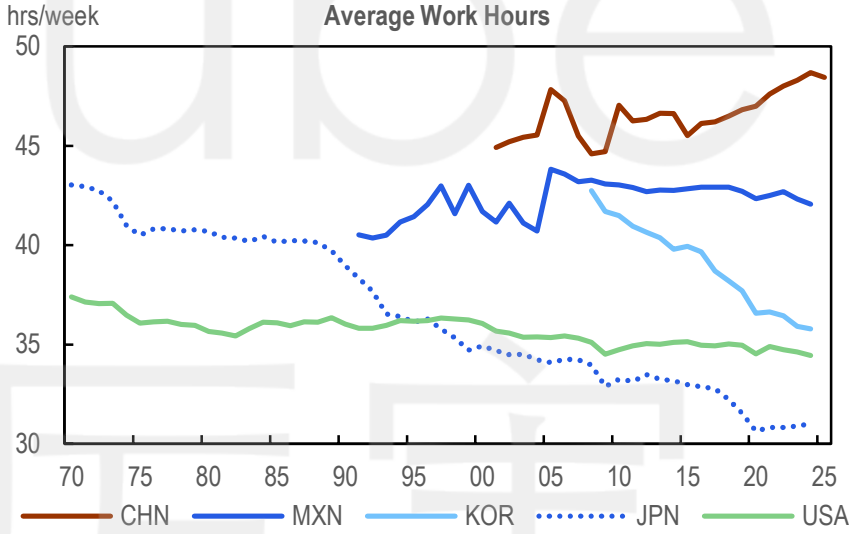




More flexible employment and longer working hours

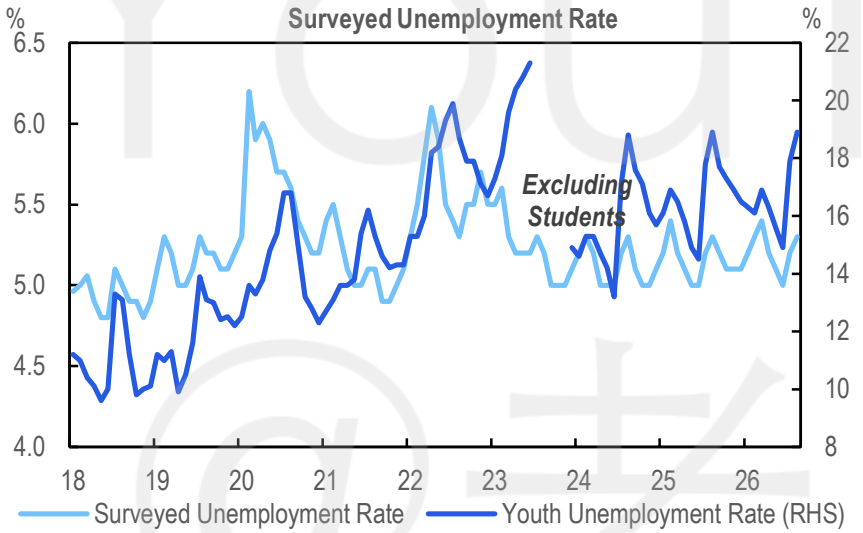
Rising job turnover has sent more workers into the gig economy;
Tech-driven productivity gains haven't cut working hours, against the global trend

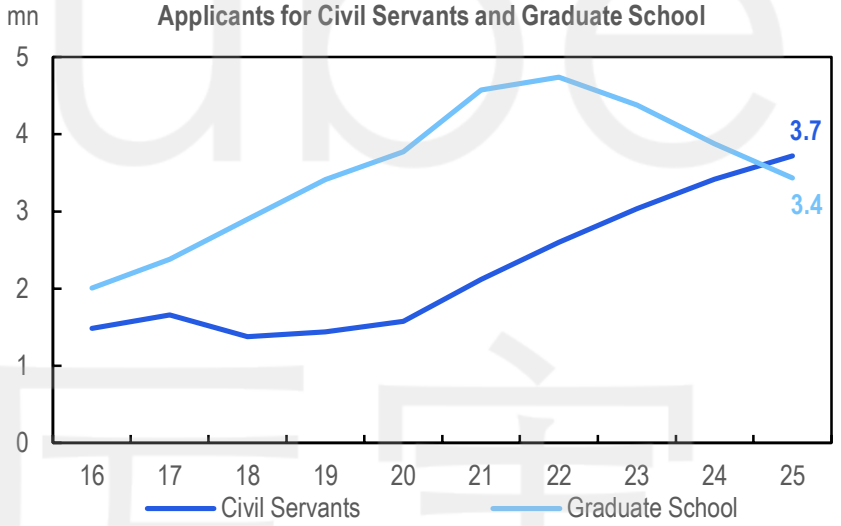




Youth unemployment stands out as most acute

Rising college enrolment keeps adding to youth jobless pressure;
More vulnerable to tech shocks, youth are flight-to-safety bound for government roles

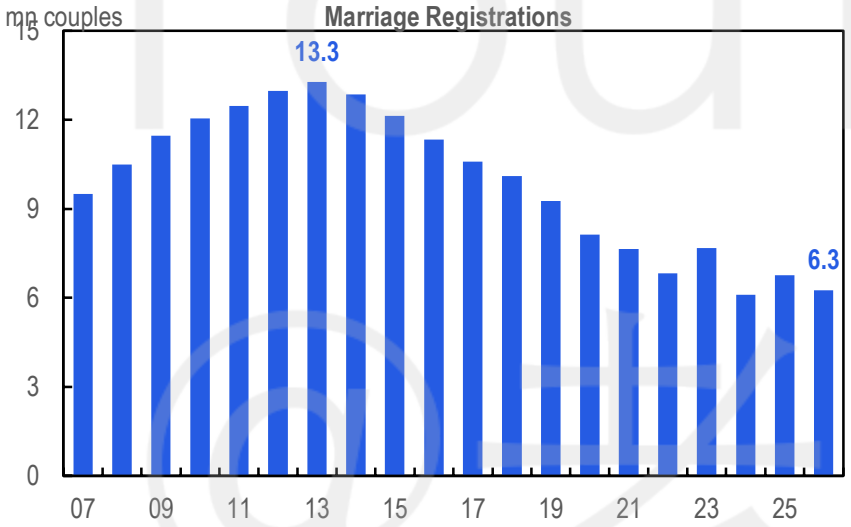


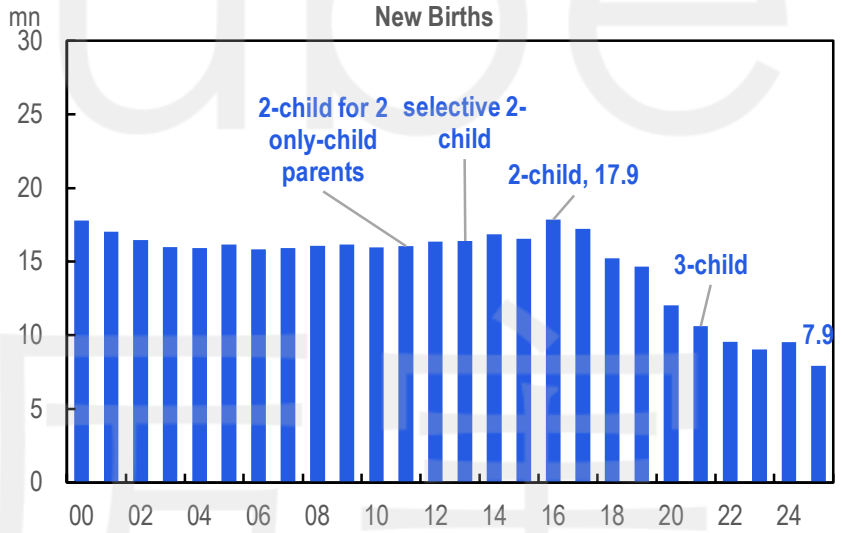


ind, Xinhua, Citi Research

Weak expectations feed long-term risks

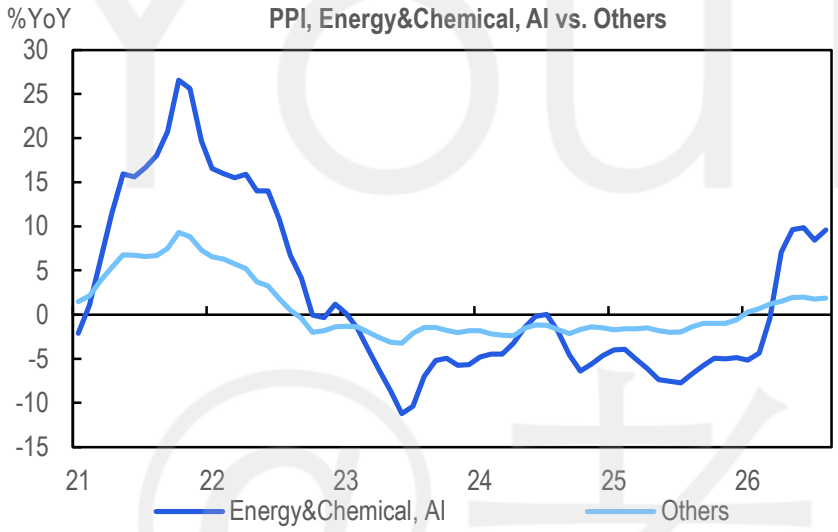
Marriage registrations have fallen at a -5.8% CAGR over the past decade;
New births have more than halved since the 2026 peak, despite boosting efforts

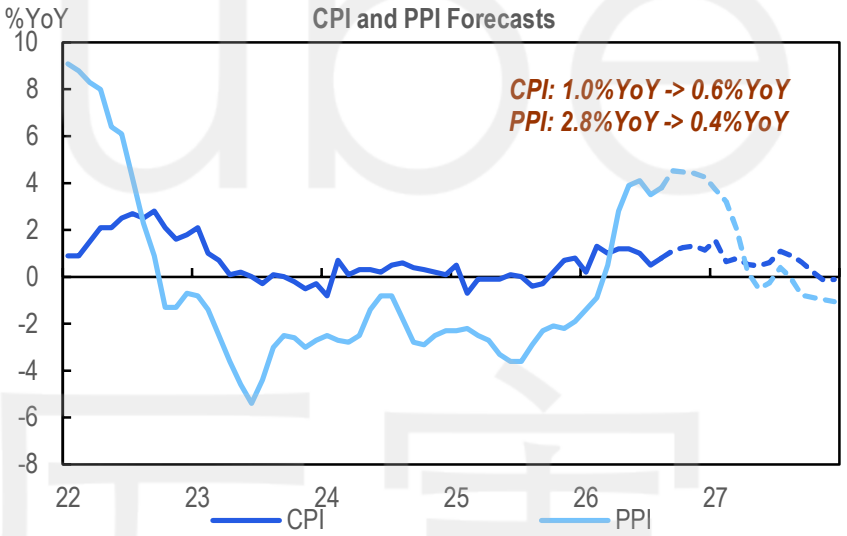




Back to deflation

Domestic PPI reflation looks more muted at ~2% YoY, excluding energy, chemicals and AI; PPI to turn negative again if oil normalizes toward Citi's 2027E Brent forecast of US$66/bbl





Note: see Global Commodities - Commodities Outlook - 4Q'26: Conflicts and El Niño skew commodity and inflation risks higher, but what's likely to happen? for commodity forecasts

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Approaching policy inflection point

A "9.24"-style pivot, echoing Sept 2024, looks more plausible in 2027 if not now, with rising economic and social pressures

	Urgency	2027	24-Sep-2024
GDP Growth	↑	**"Protect 4 (保四)"** Growth risks falling <4% as exports cool, threatening medium-term goals	**"Protect 5 (保五)"** Full-year ~5% target at risk as growth runs at 4.8% in 25Q1-3
Labor Market	↑	Youth underemployment accumulates amid rising **tech disruptions**	Job & income pressures fueled **social events** and **poverty relapse**
Fiscal Stress	↑	Gov has already tightened collection of **taxes and social security contributions**; A bigger hole in land revenue ahead, after the **completed-home sales** reform	Gov stepped up **fines & fees**, as well as **cross-regional enforcement** (远洋捕捞); Outright revenue shortfall amid **property downturn** and at the height of **deflation**
Debt Risk	–	Focus shifting toward **payment arrears** (企业欠款) as debt swap mostly concludes	Imminent **LGFV debt risks** threatening banking stability
Social Sentiment	–	Entrenched **consumer confidence** likely turns to faster deleveraging	**Business sentiment** near the bottom before DeepSeek and President Xi's meeting with private entrepreneurs in early 2025
Inflation	↓	PPI to turn negative again if oil price normalizes	Already 24 consecutive months of outright PPI deflation
Capital Market	↓	Tech-led K-shaped equity market performance	Broad-based weakness

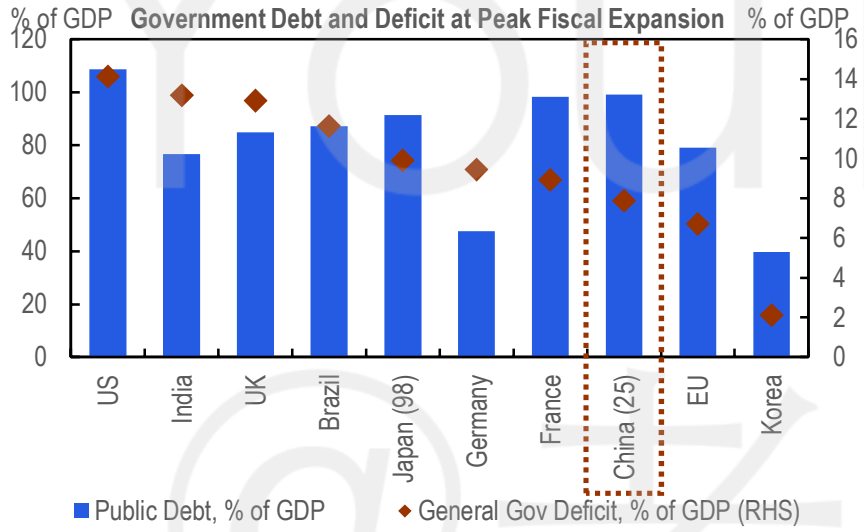
Watch year-end CEWC for pivot signals

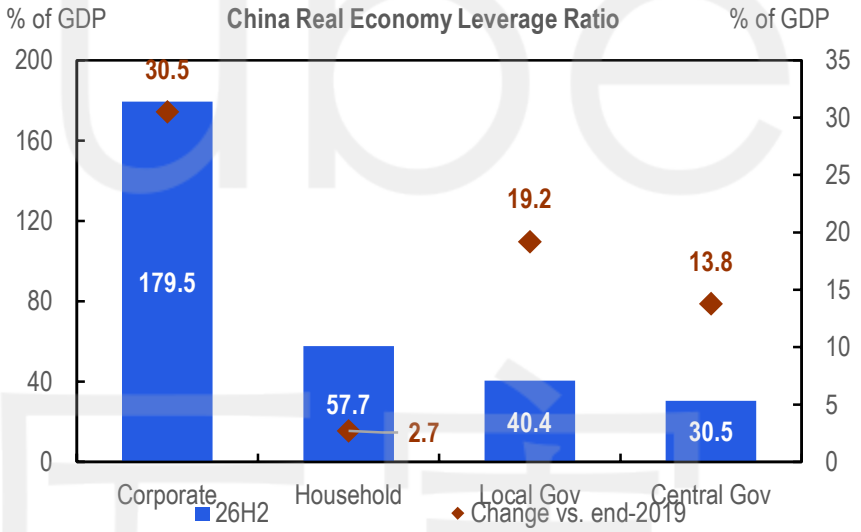
We expect augmented fiscal deficit to increase ~RMB2trn in 2027E

	Unit	2024	2025	2026	2027 Citi Forecast
Targets					
GDP Growth	%YoY	Around 5%	Around 5%	4.5~5%	**4.5~5%**
New Urban Employment	mn ppl	Above 12mn	Above 12mn	Above 12mn	**Above 12mn**
CPI	%YoY	Around 3%	Around 2%	Around 2%	**Around 2%**
Carbon Emission			~ -3% (energy intensity)	~ -3.8%	**~-3.8%**
Consumption Ratio	% of GDP			--	**--**
Monetary Policies					
Rate Cut	bps	10bp + 20bp	10bp	--	**2*10bp**
RRR Cut	bps	2*50bp	50bp	--	**50bp**
Fiscal Policies					
Pro-growth borrowing	**RMB trn (% of GDP)**	***8.7 (6.4%)***	***10.8 (7.6%)***	***11.3 (7.6%)***	***12.8 (8.4%)***
Budget deficit	RMB trn (% of GDP)	4.06 (3%)	5.66 (4%)	5.89 (4%)	**6.89 (4.5%)**
Special CGB	RMB bn	1,000	1,300	1,300	**1,800**
Trade-in subsidies	RMB bn	*150*	*300*	*250*	***200***
Equipment upgrade	RMB bn	*150*	*200*	*200*	***200***
Key projects	RMB bn	*700*	*800*	*800*	***800***
Invest-in-people subsidies	RMB bn	--	--	--	***500***
New special LGB	RMB bn	3,100	3,600	3,600	**4,100**
Unused LGB quota	RMB bn		200	**500**	**--**
Risk-resolution borrowing	**RMB trn (% of GDP)**	***3.2 (2.4%)***	***3.6 (2.5%)***	***3.1 (2.1%)***	***2.8 (1.8%)***
CGB for FI	RMB bn	--	500	300	**--**
New special LGB	RMB bn	800	800	800	**800**
Unused LGB quota	RMB bn	400	300	--	**--**
Swap bonds	RMB bn	2,000	2000	2000	**--**
LGB to address arrears	RMB bn	--	--	--	**2,000**
Quasi-Fiscal					
Policy-finance tool	RMB bn (leverage)	--	500 (>10x)	800 (>10x)	**1000 (>10x)**

Fiscal policy: how much room for further expansion?

Fiscal policy has turned expansionary, but trails peak levels elsewhere;
With leverage still low and only modestly up since Covid, the central government can do more of the heavy lifting



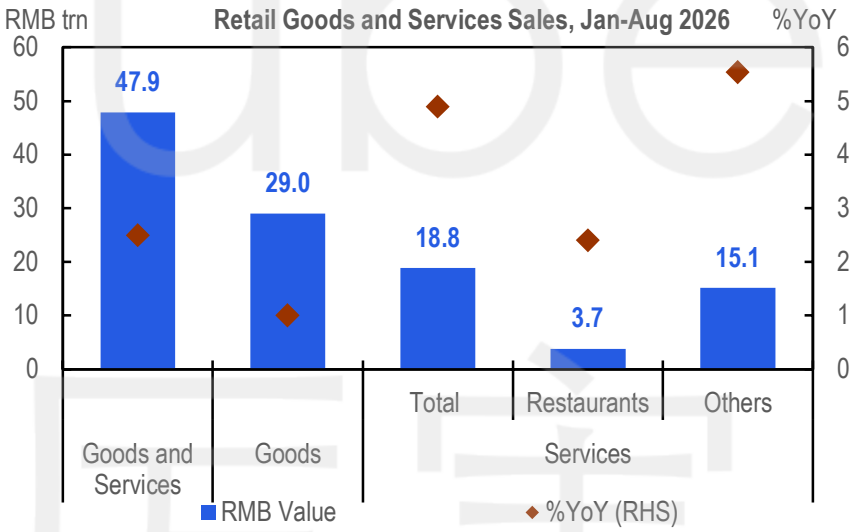


Haver Analytics, Wind, Citi Research

Time for direct household transfers

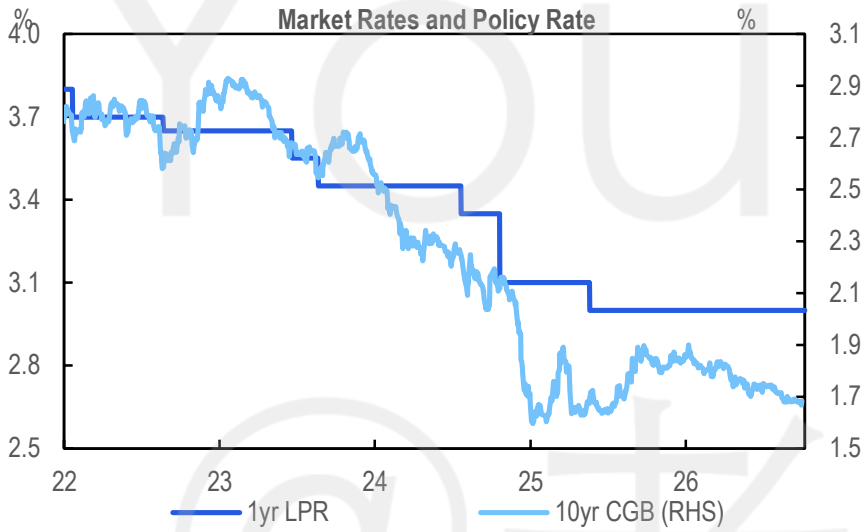
Conventional measures, from trade-in to interest subsidies, have shown diminishing impact; With durable goods consumption hard to lift further, the next round could focus on social security and consumer services

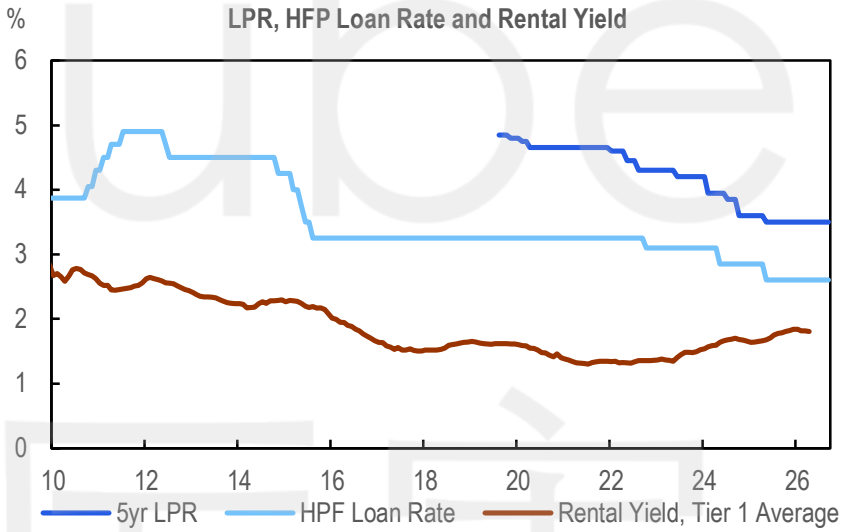
	Childcare Subsidies	Free Pre-school Education	Trade-in Subsidies	Elderly Care Coupon	Interest Subsidies
2024	0	0	150	NA	NA
2025	100	20	300	Pilot	Consumer Loans
2026	110	40 (est.)	250	National	Consumer Loans + Mortgage



Monetary policy: more cuts in 2027 after a 2026 hold

Market rates are likely drift lower anyway, even if LPR stays unchanged;
Mortgage rates remain too high relative to rental yields for property to stabilize



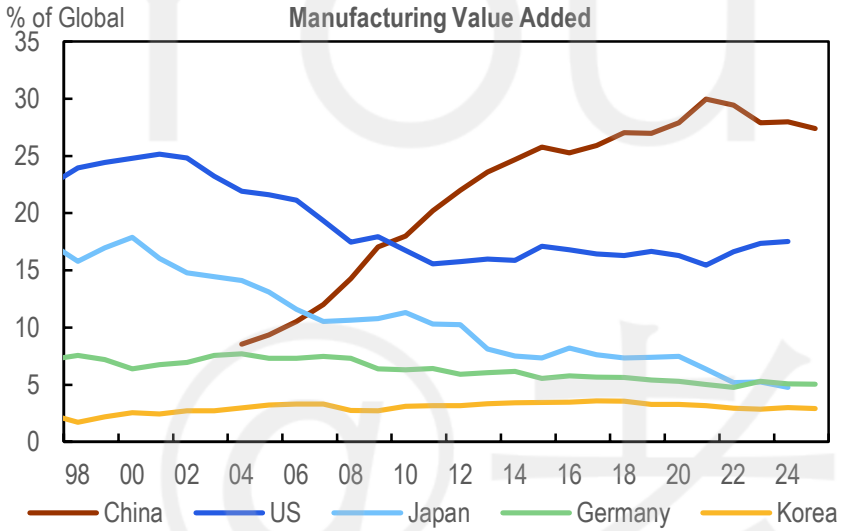


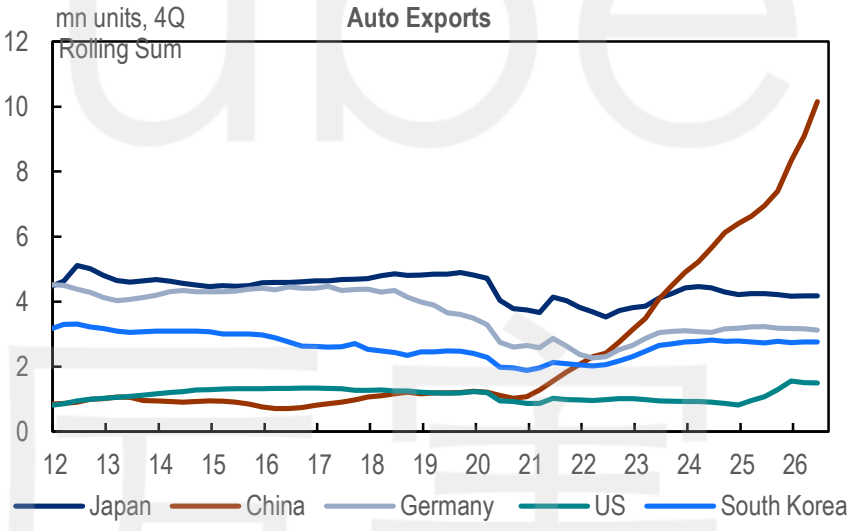
Global tech power rebalancing

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China manufacturing emerges stronger from tariff, Covid and energy shocks

China accounted for ~27% of global manufacturing in 2025;
Case in point: auto exports continued to skyrocket after leapfrogging other auto giants



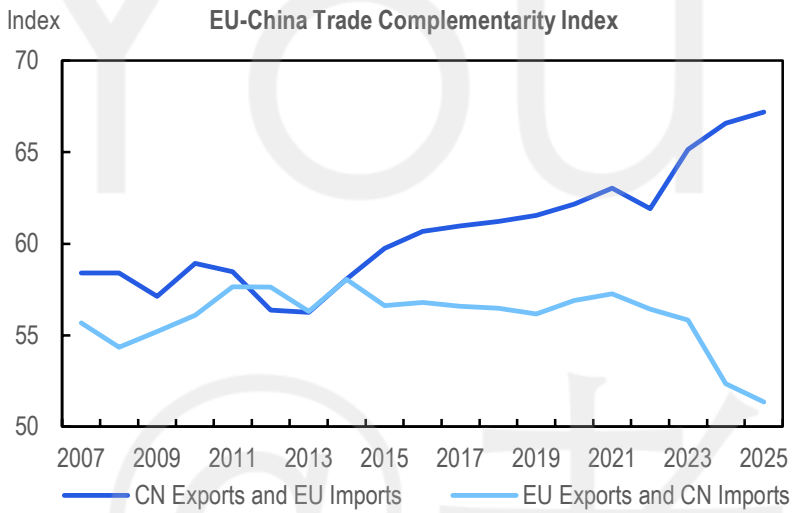


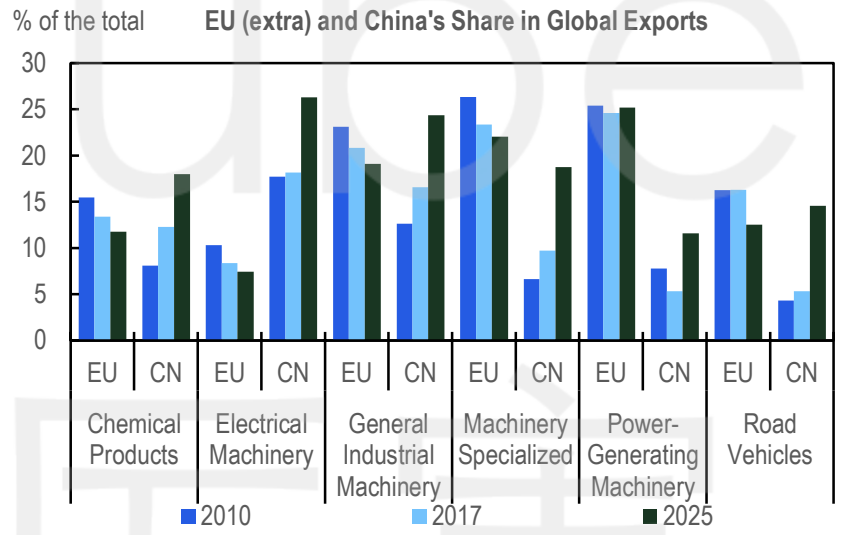
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ade statistics sources, Haver Analytics, CEIC, Citi Research

A rewriting of global supply chains with EU-China trade as example

Chinese exports meet EU demand increasingly better, but not the other way around; European companies face intensive competition with Chinese rivals in key sectors globally

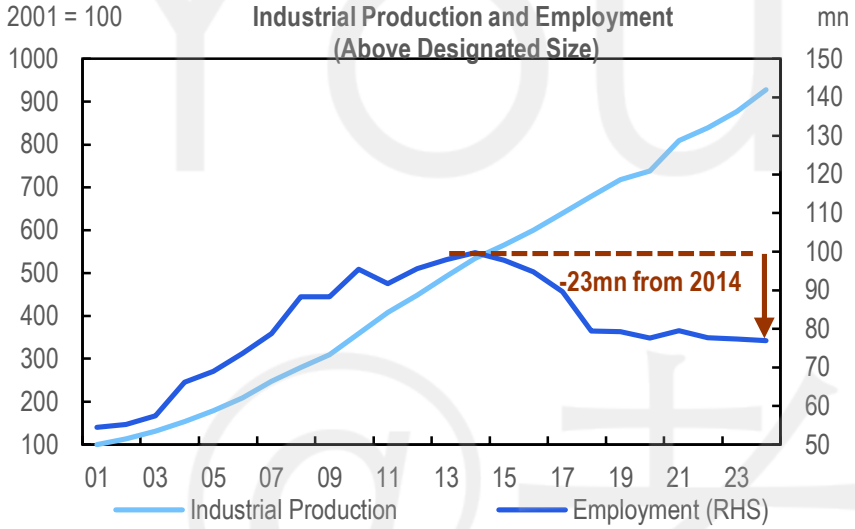


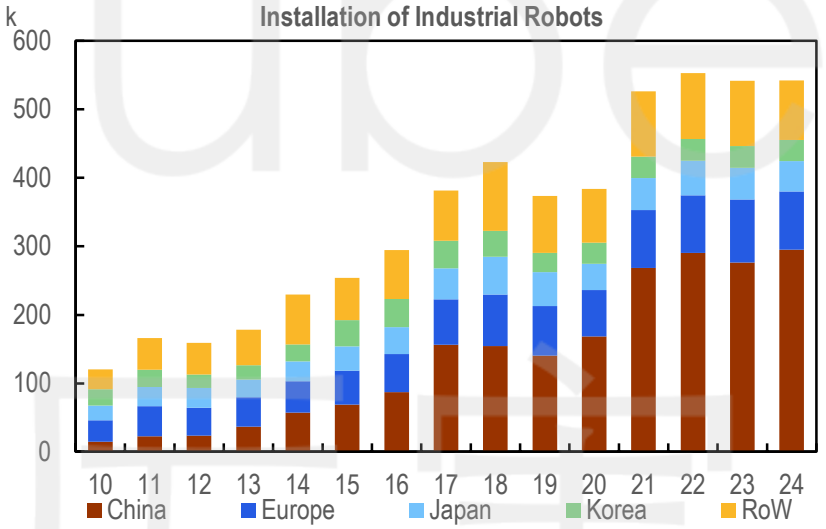


OMTRADE, Citi Research

The “Lewis turning point” overcome

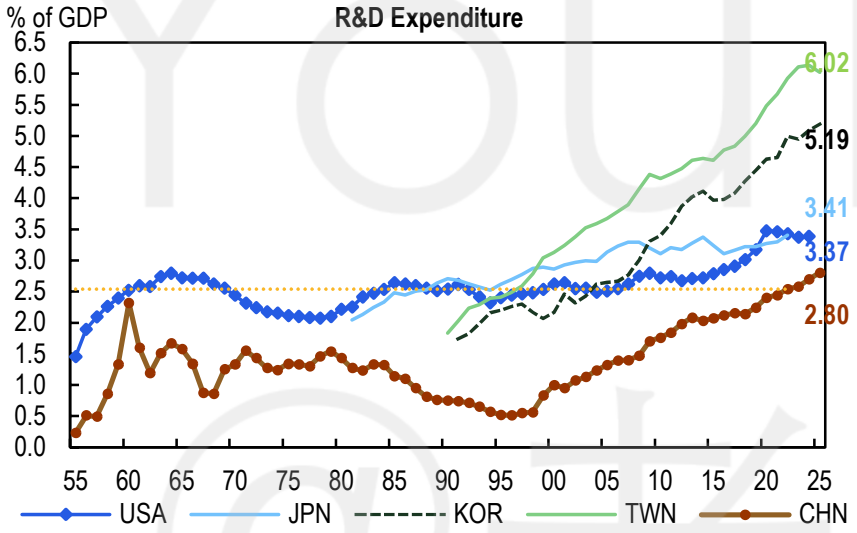
IP has grown steadily despite shrinking labor inputs, thanks to productivity improvements;
More than half of new industrial robot installations globally happened in China in 2024

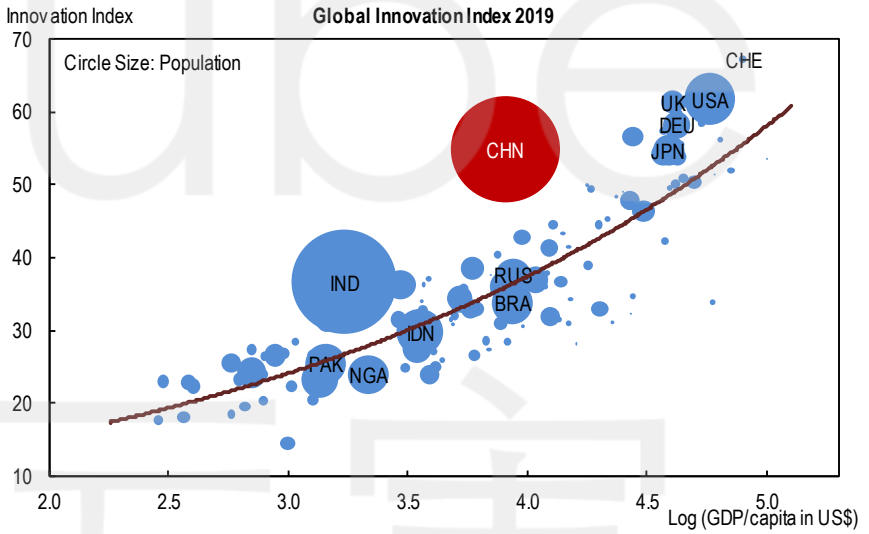




“New productive forces”: the next focus

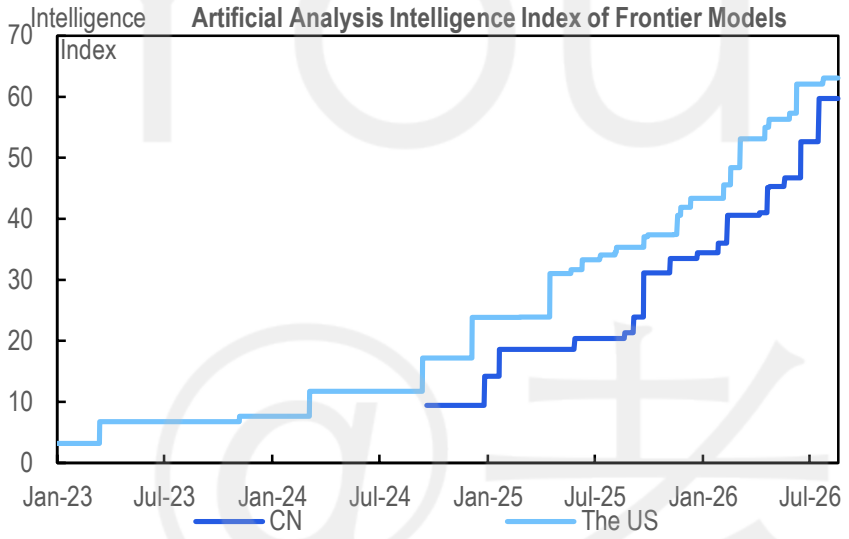
R&D spending reached RMB3.9trn (2.8% of GDP) in 2025, targeting >7% annual growth under the 15th FYP;
China’s innovation performance stands out relative to its income level

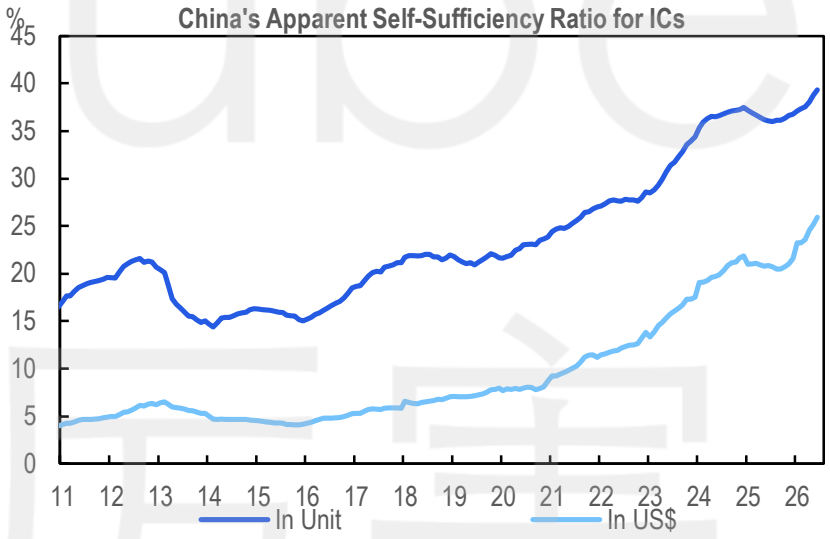




A great tech catch-up in play

Model: US-China gap in LLM performance has been narrowing; Hardware: China's chip self-sufficiency ratio more than doubled in the past decade

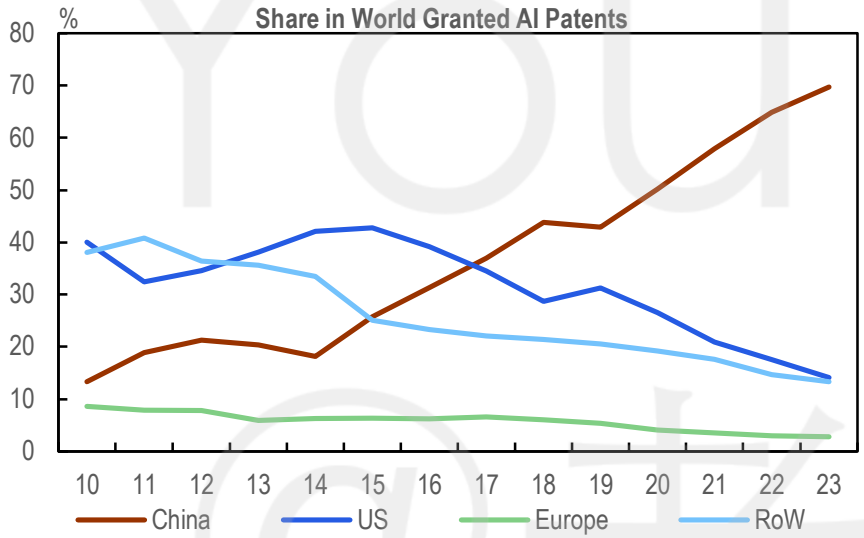


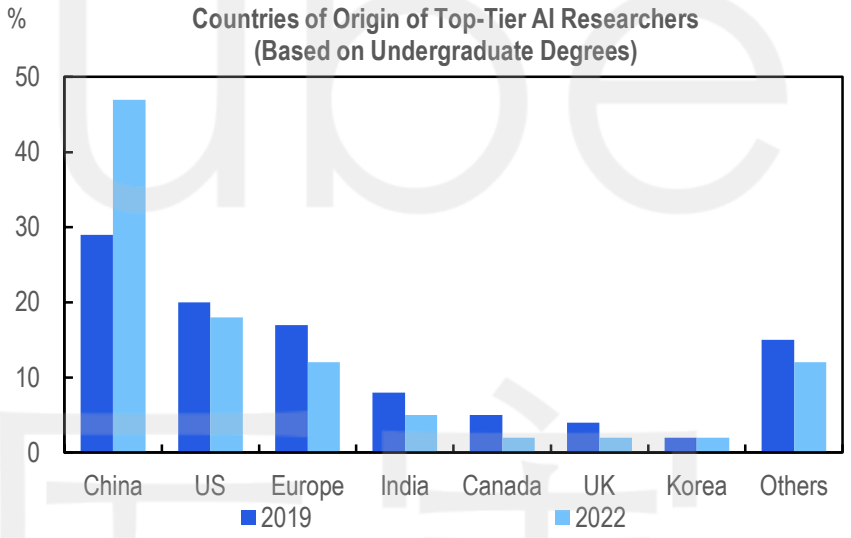


Note: Apparent Self-Sufficiency Ratio = (Domestic Production - Non-processing Exports) / (Domestic Production - Non-processing Exports + Imports)
Customs, NBS, Wind, Citi Research, Citi Global Tech Research

Potential to become a global center for “AI+”

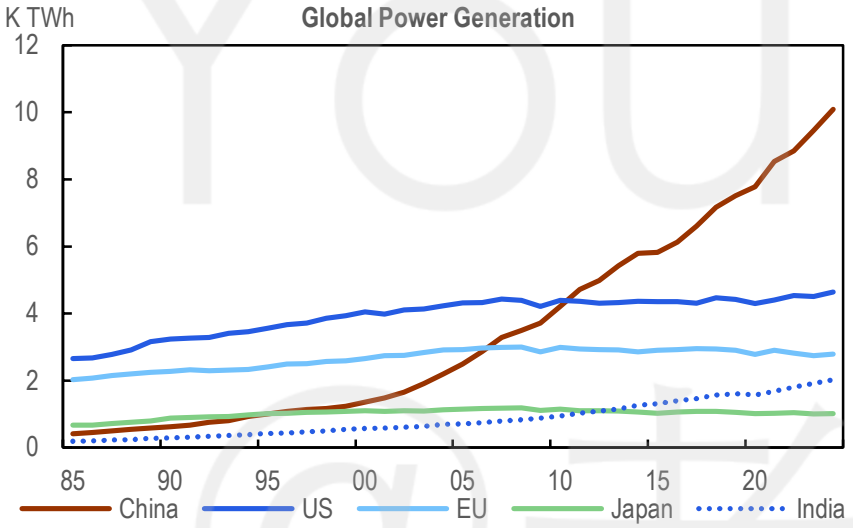
China held 69.7% of global AI patents vs. 14.2% for the US in 2023;
China has surpassed the US to become the top producer of AI talent

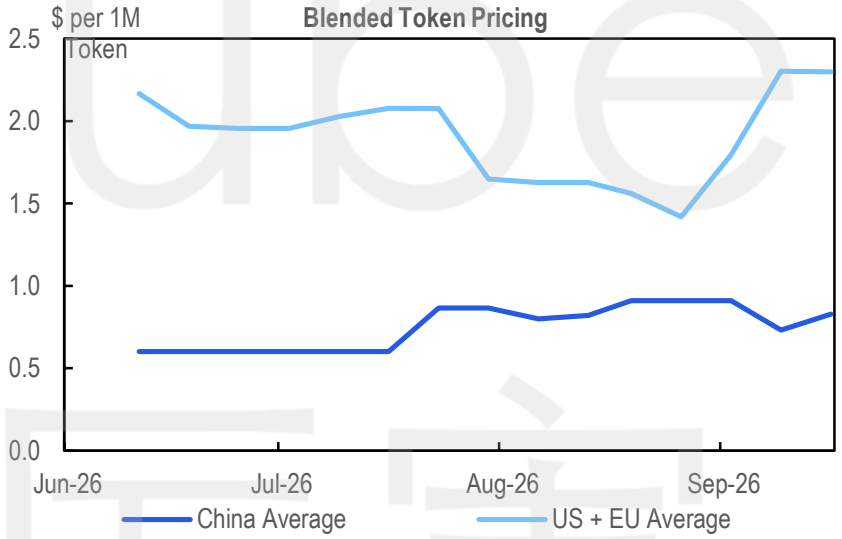




Robust industrial ecosystem + power infrastructure

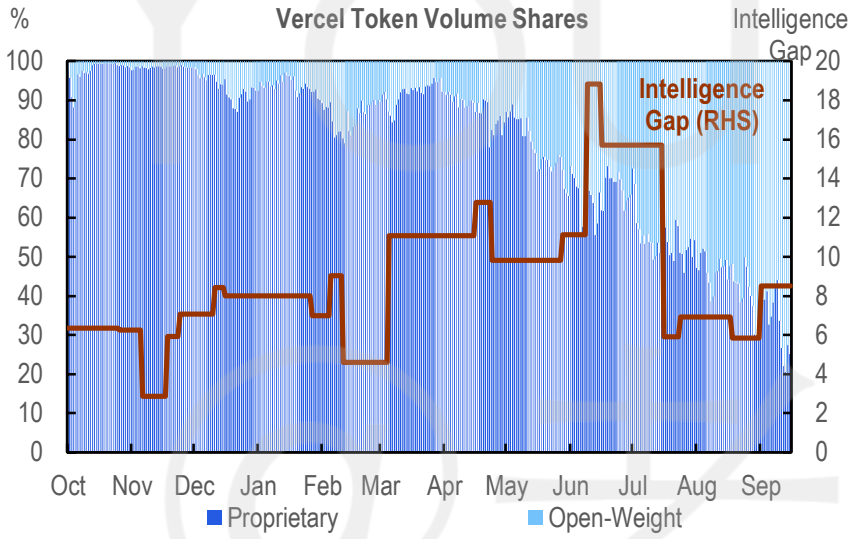
China produced 32.3% of the world's electricity in 2025;
China's pricing edge extends to the AI domain

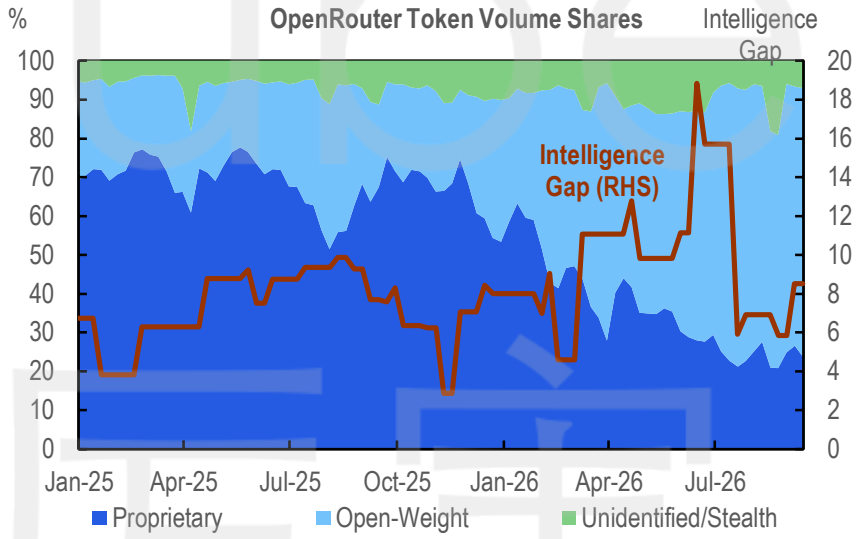




Open-weight models are capturing more share

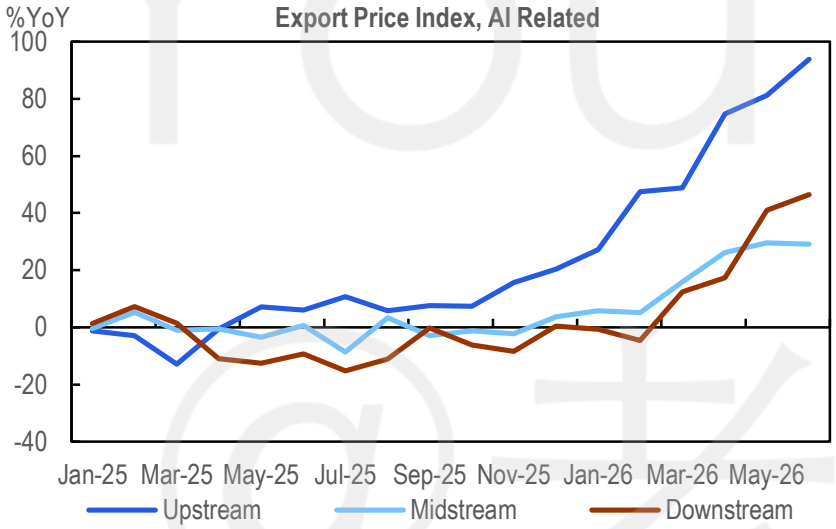
China can be a key driving force for open-weight model development and adoption, leveraging its pricing and access advantages

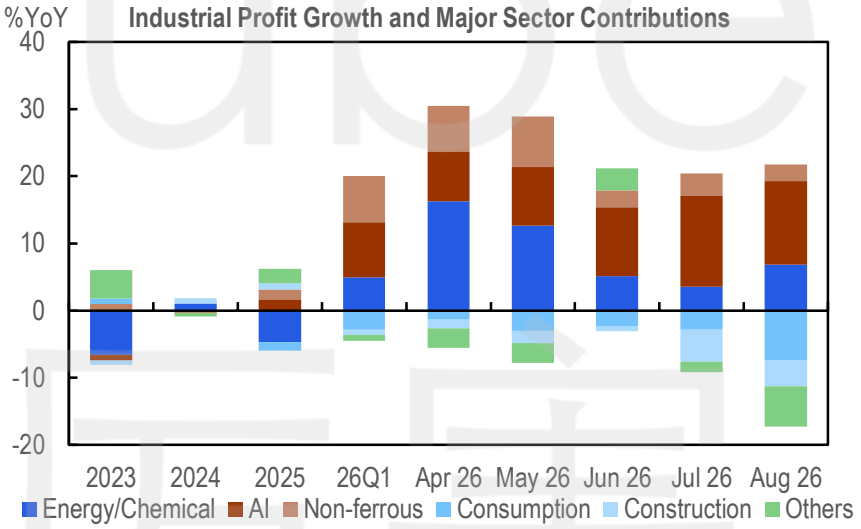




China also occupies a key position in global AIDC supply chains

AI exports have logged strong price momentum across the supply chain in recent quarters; Profit rebounds have been concentrated in a handful of sectors, including AI hardware

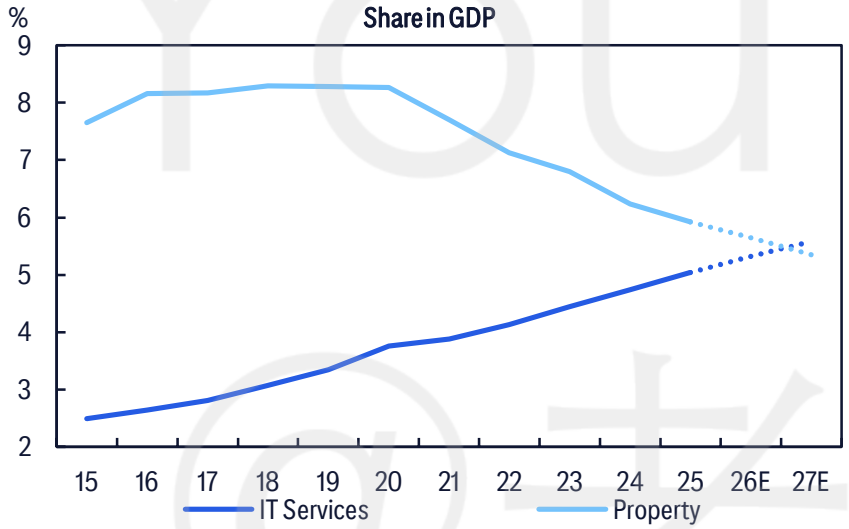


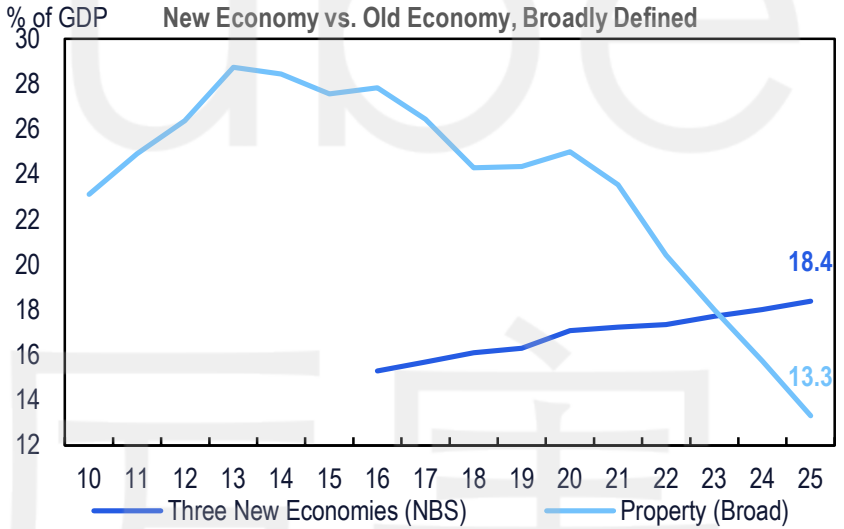


EIC, Citi Research

The new economy is macro relevant

IT services alone can exceed the property sector in scale by 2027E;
The "three new economies" has outsized the property supply chain – broadly defined

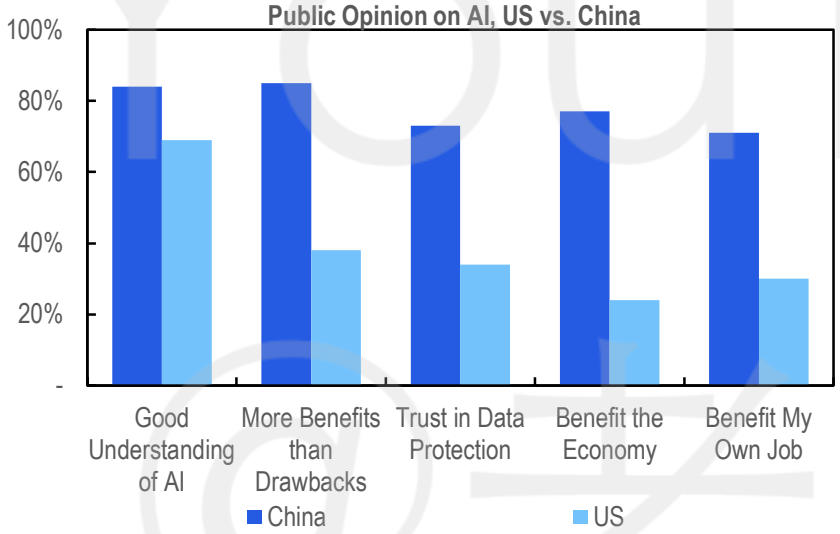


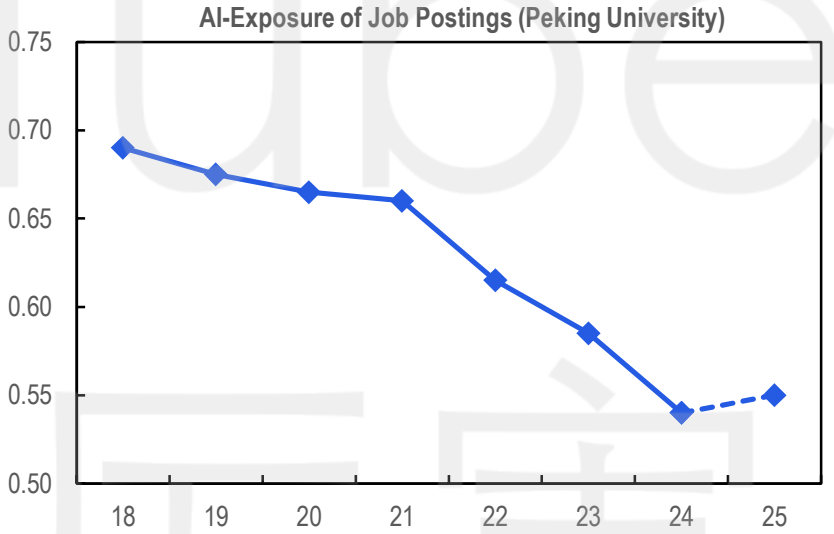


"three new economies" = a collection of economic activities with new industries, new formats and new business models as their core

Pacing AI relative to social impact

Public opinion on AI appears more positive in China than in the US;
Real impact is surfacing in China's labor market, with postings shifting toward low-AI-exposure roles





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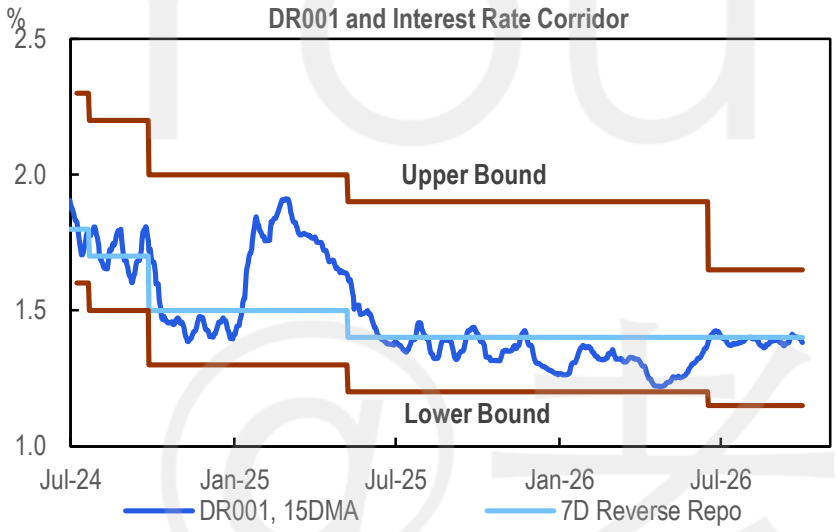
_____, Peking University, Citi Research

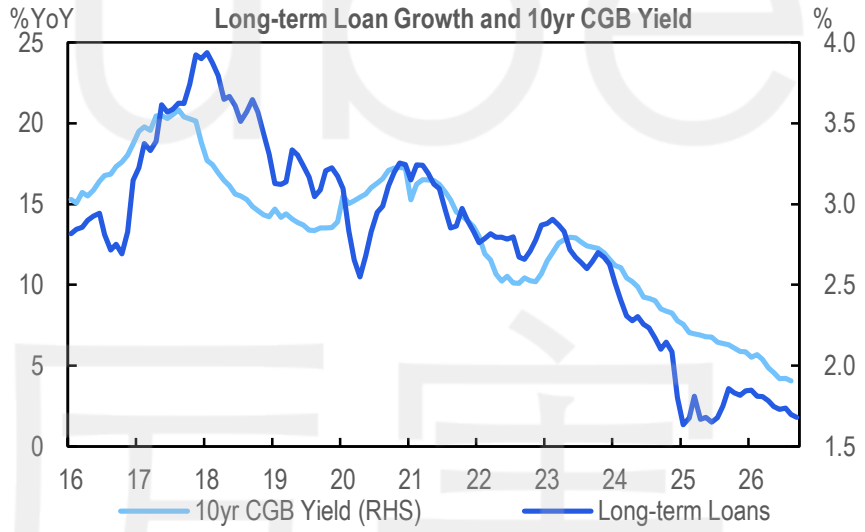
Market implications

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Rates set to stay lower for longer

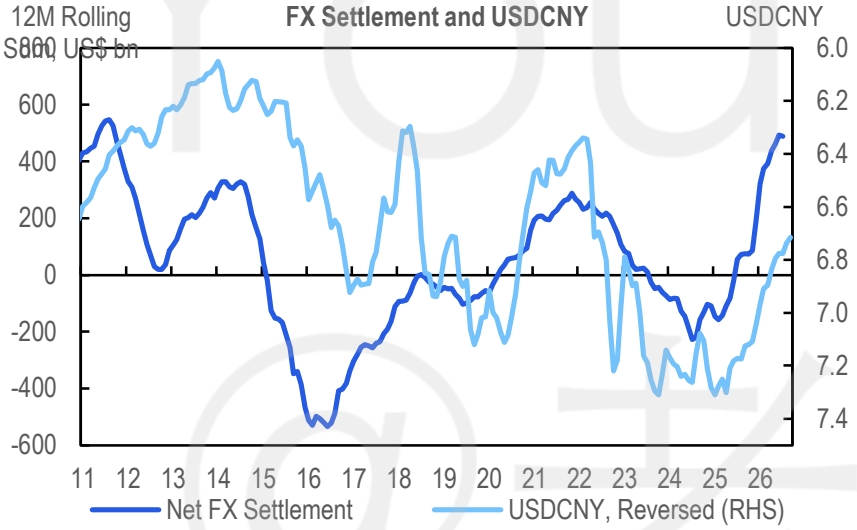
Short-term rates, anchored by the PBoC, would ease further on two cuts;
CGB yields track old-economy dynamics more closely

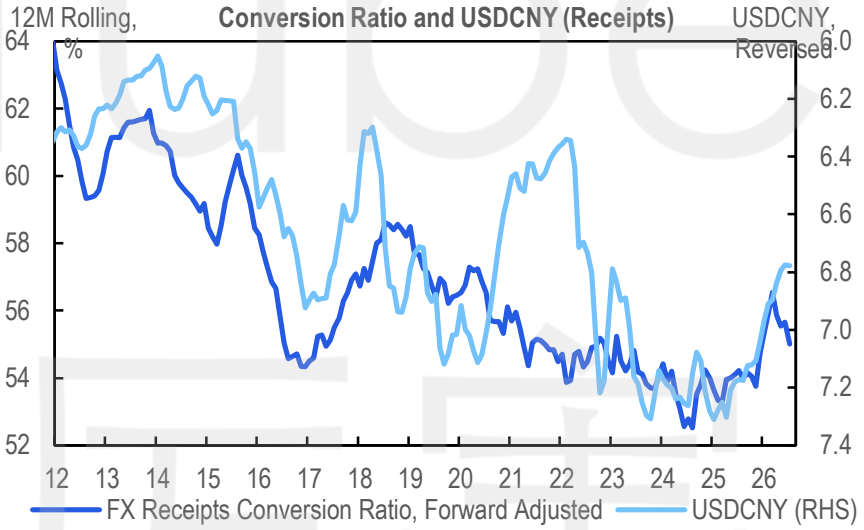




FX is caught between record-high trade surplus…

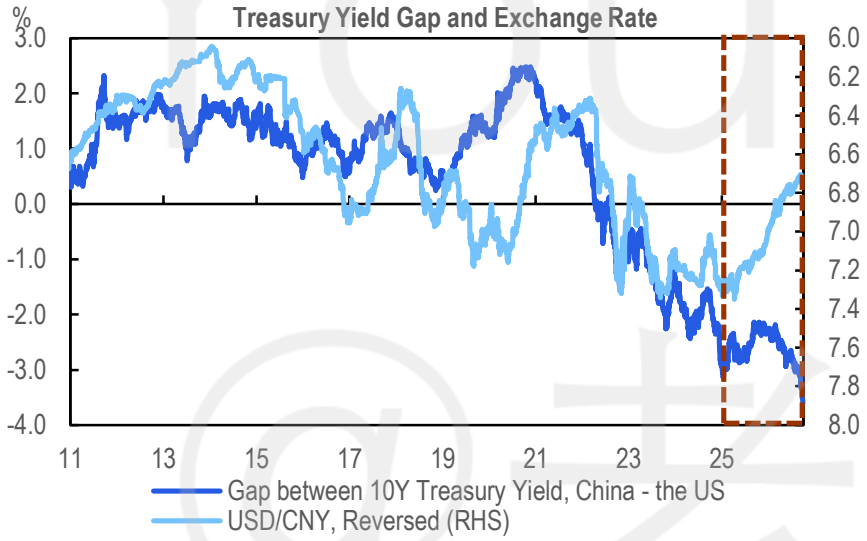
FX settlement hit a decade high in Aug 2026 on a 12-month rolling basis, acting as the primary driver of recent RMB appreciation; Exporter conversion ratio has risen, as FX gains outweigh interest losses

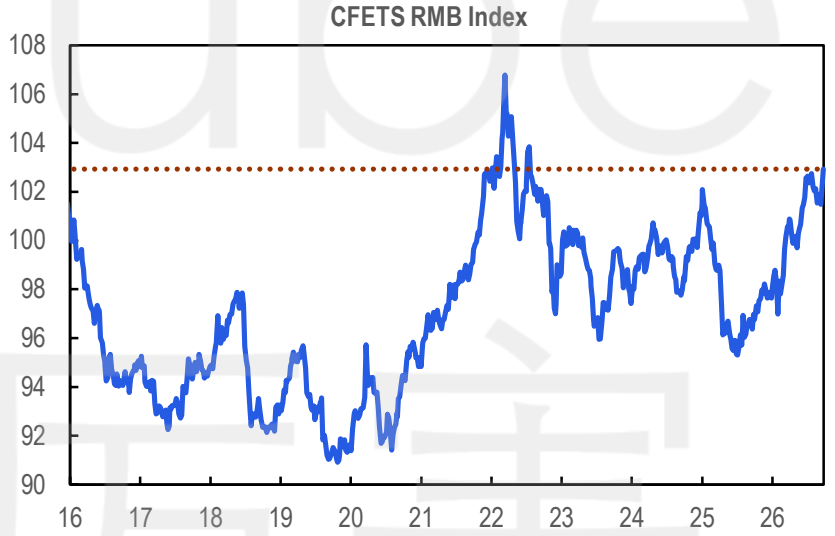




… and record-high yield differential

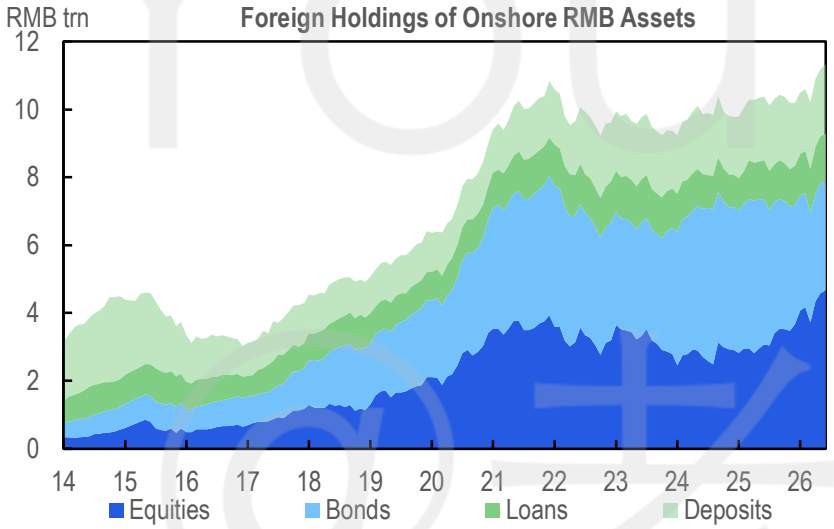
The current round of RMB appreciation has decoupled from the carry narrative;
The PBoC's trade-weighted CFETS index has recovered to its highest level since mid-2022

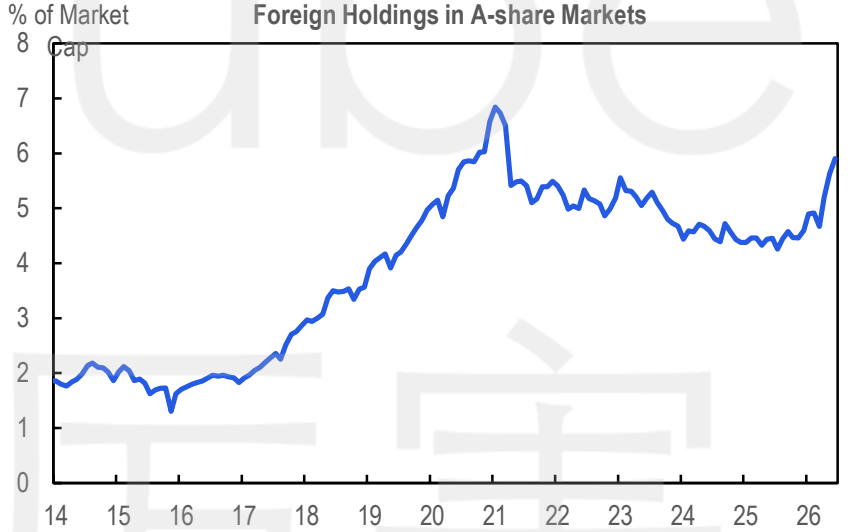




Foreign equity holdings more steady than thought

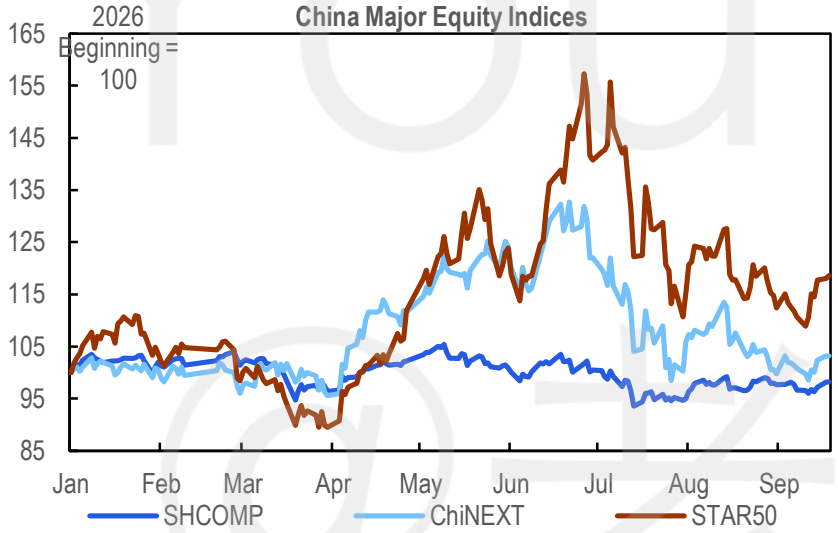
Foreign holdings of A-shares held steady at RMB4.7trn as of mid-2026, yet their share of market cap hasn't recovered to the 2020 peak

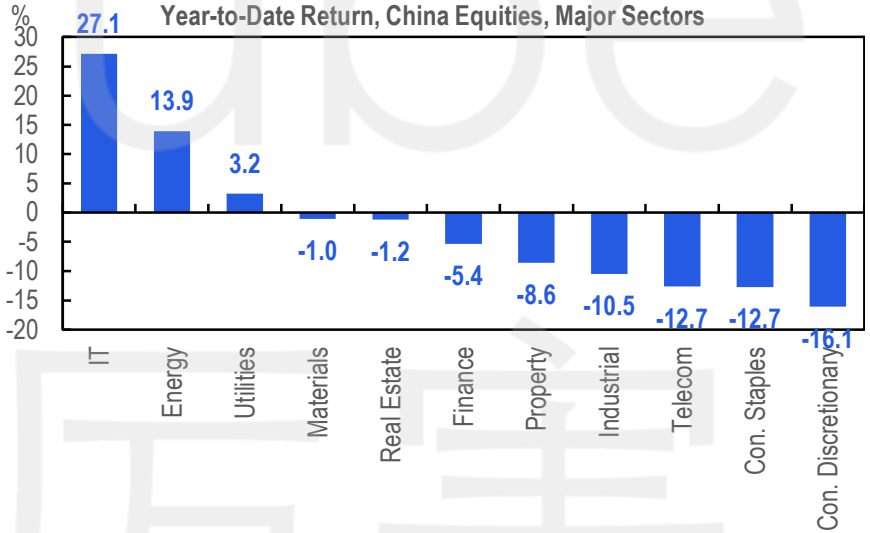




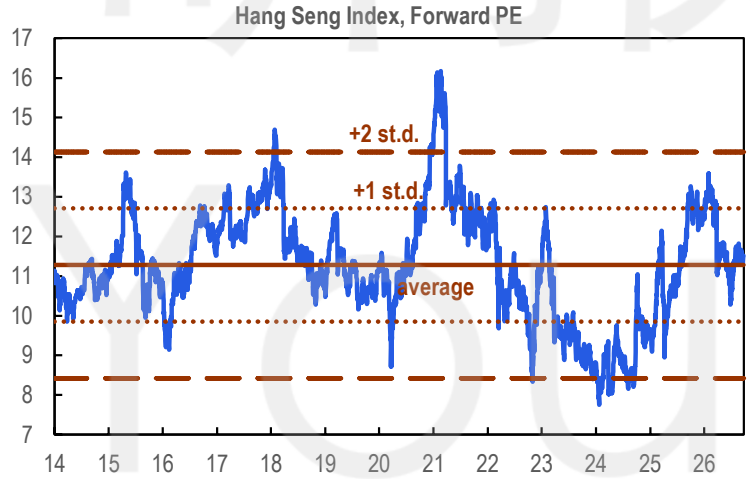
A K-shaped equity market

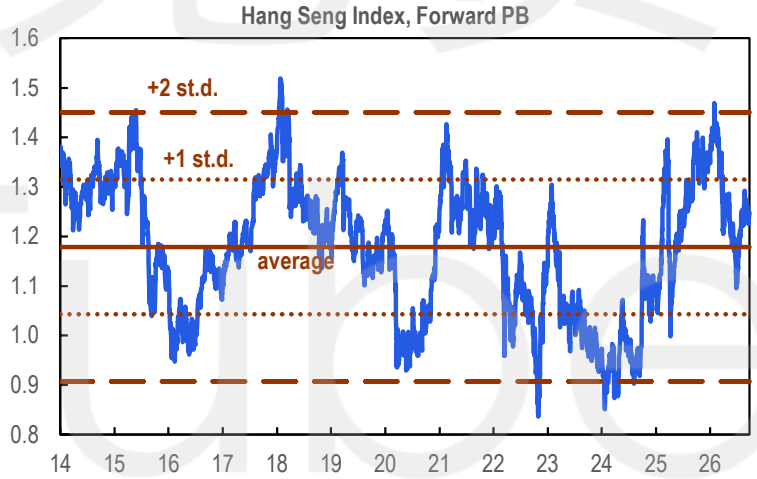
China equities have shown a clear tech-driven K-shape since the DeepSeek moment, with consumer names underperforming

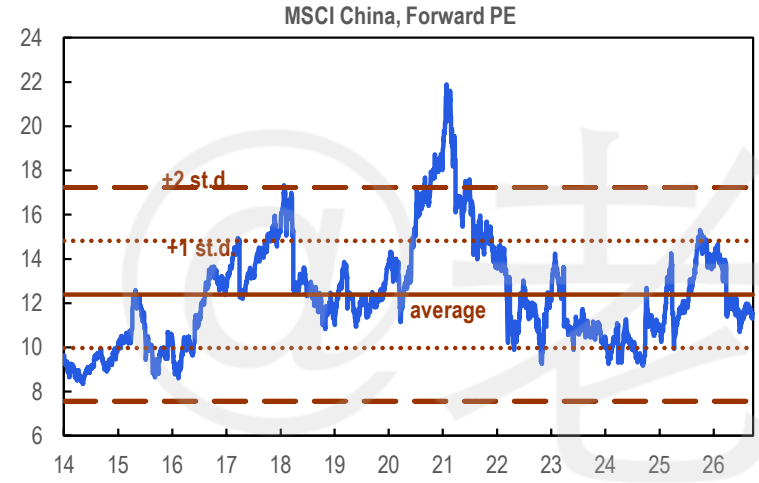


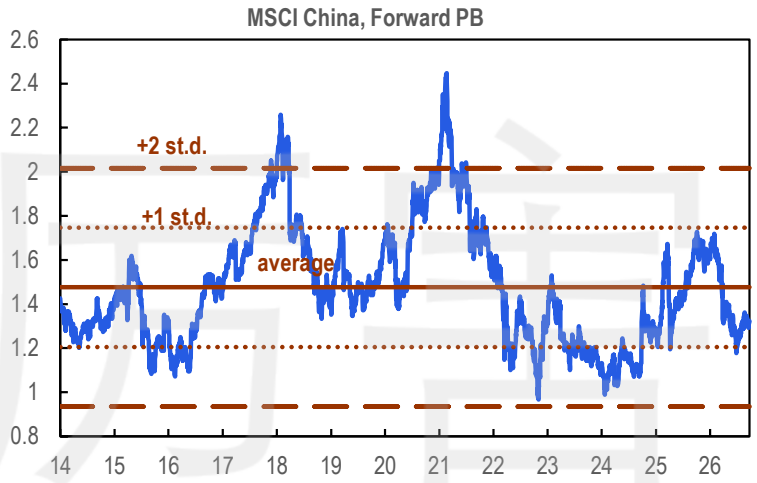


Valuation


Hang Seng Index, Forward PE
+2 st.d.
+1 st.d.
average


Hang Seng Index, Forward PB
+2 st.d.
+1 st.d.
average


MSCI China, Forward PE
+2 st.d.
+1 st.d.
average


MSCI China, Forward PB
+2 st.d.
+1 st.d.
average

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Appendix A-1

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